STUDENTS' BOOKLET

TECHNICAL TRANSLATION

MEDICAL | LEGAL | TECHNICAL | MEDIA

LEVEL	Third-year undergraduate (L3)
INSTITUTION	Faculty of Arts and Humanities of Sousse · University of Sousse
ACADEMIC YEAR	2026–2027 · Fall semester

Name: …… Group: ……

Instructor: ……

Contents and Course Calendar

Twelve lectures, five parts, one workflow

Week	Lecture	Field	Focus	Page
PART A · FOUNDATIONS				
1	**1.** What Is Technical Translation?	Foundations	Scope, features, competence	6
2	**2.** Skopos, the Brief and Text Function	Foundations	Purpose, brief, loyalty	11
3	**3.** Terminology and Equivalence	Foundations	Terms and equivalence	16
4	**4.** Syntax, Style and Cohesion	Foundations	Sentence structure, cohesion	21
PART B · MEDICAL TRANSLATION				
5	**5.** Patient Information and Health Communication	Medical	Leaflets, health communication	26
6	**6.** Clinical and Research Texts	Medical	Clinical texts, ethics	31
PART C · LEGAL TRANSLATION				
7	**7.** Legal Language and Contracts	Legal	Contracts, legal systems	36
8	**8.** Legislation, Judgments and Certified Translation	Legal	Judgments, certified translation	41
PART D · TECHNICAL TRANSLATION				
9	**9.** Instructions, Manuals and Safety Texts	Technical	Manuals, usability	46
10	**10.** Scientific, IT and Machine Translation	Technical	Scientific, IT, MT	51
PART E · MEDIA TRANSLATION				
11	**11.** News Translation	Media	News, headlines, attribution	57
12	**12.** Audiovisual, Social Media and Campaign Texts	Media	Subtitling, campaigns, synthesis	62
Weeks 13–14: Revision, portfolio submission and final examination				
Back matter: Technical word lists (medical, legal, technical, media) p. 67 · My termbase p. 69 · Bibliography p. 70				

How to use this booklet

THEORY	Short lecture notes with the key ideas of each lecture.
TOOLKIT	Contrastive tables with ready-to-use English–Arabic solutions.
WARM-UP	Questions to think about and answer in the spaces provided.
TEXT A / B	Source texts in each direction, with a terminology bank, "watch out" points and writing lines.
PRACTICE	Two shorter extra texts per lecture (one in each direction) for independent practice.
LOG	Your translator's log: reflect, justify, record terms.

All source texts in this booklet were written for classroom use or are fictional; names, numbers, laws and events in them are invented. Always check real documents against current official sources.

Course Description

Technical Translation · L3 · Fall 2026–2027

Course	Technical Translation (English–Arabic–English)
Level	Third-year undergraduate (L3)
Institution	Faculty of Arts and Humanities of Sousse, University of Sousse
Term	Fall semester, academic year 2026–2027
Format	12 weekly lectures of 1 h 30 (mini-lecture and translation workshop), followed by revision and examination
Working languages	English and Modern Standard Arabic
Prerequisites	Introduction to Translation Studies; advanced English; advanced Arabic writing
Instructor	……

Overview

Technical translation is the translation of texts that belong to specialised fields and serve practical purposes: a leaflet that tells a patient how to take a medicine, a contract that fixes rights and duties, a manual that guides a repair, a news report that informs a nation. This course introduces you to the theory and practice of translating such texts between English and Arabic, in both directions.

We use "technical translation" in its broad, professional sense (Wright & Wright 1993; Olohan 2016) and organise the course around four fields in which graduates of English Studies most often work: **medical**, **legal**, **technical** (scientific, engineering and IT) and **media** texts. Each lecture combines a short theoretical input, practical notes on the field, two main texts to translate (one from English into Arabic and one from Arabic into English) and two shorter practice texts. Word lists for the four fields complete the booklet. A functionalist approach (Reiss & Vermeer; Nord 1997) runs through the course: the purpose and readers of a translation determine how it is translated.

Aims

- Introduce the concepts and debates of technical and specialised translation.
- Develop systematic methods for analysing, researching, drafting and revising specialised texts.
- Build English–Arabic terminological competence and research autonomy.
- Familiarise students with the genres and conventions of medical, legal, technical and media discourse.
- Encourage critical, ethical and technology-aware professional practice.

Learning outcomes

By the end of the course you will be able to:

1. Define technical translation and explain how it differs from literary and general translation.
2. Analyse a source text and a translation brief using functionalist criteria.
3. Find, evaluate and record Arabic and English terminology using reliable sources.
4. Identify and reproduce the conventions of leaflets, clinical texts, contracts, judgments, manuals, news and subtitles.
5. Produce accurate, readable and fit-for-purpose translations in both directions.

6 Revise and post-edit translations and machine translation output.

7 Reflect on and justify translation decisions, and apply professional ethics.

Pedagogical Framework

How the course teaches and how you will learn

The course follows a functionalist, genre-based and task-oriented approach to translator training. Your development is understood as the growth of translation competence: bilingual and extra-linguistic knowledge, knowledge about translation, instrumental skills (research, terminology, tools) and strategic skills for solving problems (PACTE 2003).

1. Purpose before form

Every task starts with a brief: who reads the translation, for what? Strategies follow from purpose (skopos), not from habit.

2. Genre and text type

Each lecture is anchored in real genres. You learn what a leaflet, a clause or a news lead looks like in both languages.

3. Learning by translating

Task-based and process-oriented: analyse, research, draft, revise and reflect on every text.

4. Contrastive, in two directions

English→Arabic and Arabic→English tasks in every lecture reveal how the two languages organise information differently.

5. Research, terminology and technology

You build a termbase, use parallel texts and authoritative sources, and learn to evaluate CAT and machine-translation tools.

6. Reflective and ethical practice

Logs, peer review and discussion develop judgement; accuracy, confidentiality and responsibility are part of every lecture.

Anatomy of a lecture (90 minutes)

Phase	Time	In this booklet	What you do
Warm-up	10 min	Think and discuss	Activate what you know; share experiences.
Mini-lecture	25 min	Lecture notes and Toolkit	Key concepts, contrasts and ready-to-use solutions.
Analysis	10 min	Before you translate	Function, readers, problems and terms.
Workshop	35 min	Texts A and B	Translate in both directions; compare in pairs.
Debrief	10 min	Translator's log	Justify choices and record lessons and terms.

Assessment (proposed)

Component	Weight	Description
Continuous assessment	40 %	Portfolio of revised translations, termbase and translator's log (20 %); in-class translation test after Lecture 8 (20 %).
Final examination	60 %	Two-hour written exam: one English→Arabic and one Arabic→English translation with brief and a short commentary on key decisions.

Weights and formats can be adjusted to departmental regulations.

The Translator's Workflow

One method for every text in this course

1	2	3	4	5	6
PREPARE	**ANALYSE**	**RESEARCH**	**DRAFT**	**REVISE**	**REFLECT**
What is the brief?	Who, why, what genre?	Which terms and parallel texts?	Meaning first, then form.	Check against the source and the brief.	What did I learn?

Self-revision checklist

- ☐ **Meaning:** nothing added, omitted or distorted; numbers, units, negations and names checked.
- ☐ **Terminology:** each concept has one term; choices come from reliable sources and are recorded in the termbase.
- ☐ **Language:** grammar, spelling, punctuation and style are natural in the target language.
- ☐ **Genre and function:** the text looks and sounds like its target genre and fits the brief.
- ☐ **Form:** layout, numbering, headings, directionality (RTL/LTR) and symbols are correct.

Error categories used in feedback and marking

Category	Description	Example
Mistranslation	Meaning wrongly transferred.	*stress* → ضغط in engineering
Omission / addition	Content lost or invented.	Dropping *preferably* in a dose instruction
Terminology	Wrong or inconsistent term.	حاسوب and كمبيوتر in one manual
Language	Grammar, spelling, syntax, calques.	Overuse of «يتم»; "pressure of blood"
Register / genre	Style unsuited to the text type.	Colloquial wording in a contract
Form	Punctuation, numbers, layout, RTL issues.	10.000 ت.د read as ten dinars

Translation brief: quick template

Client and purpose	
Readers	
Medium and place	
Deadline and urgency	
Function	
Strategy	

LECTURE

01

WEEK 1

PART A · FOUNDATIONS

What Is Technical Translation?

Scope, text features and the translator's competence

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Define technical translation and distinguish it from scientific, specialised and literary translation.
- Identify the main features of technical texts in English and Arabic.
- Describe the competences and the workflow of a professional technical translator.
- Apply the "five questions" analysis to a text before translating it.

Lecture notes

1. Defining the field

Wright and Wright (1993) define technical translation as the translation of texts written in a Language for Special Purposes (LSP). Byrne (2006) is narrower: "technical" refers to technology and its practical use, whereas scientific translation deals with pure science. Newmark (1988) puts it neatly: scientific language is *concept-centred*, technological language is *object-centred*.

In this course we use **technical translation** in its broad, professional sense (Olohan 2016; Hassan 2017): the translation of texts whose subject matter, terminology and conventions belong to a specialised field. We work in four fields: **medical, legal, technical and media** texts.

2. Features of technical texts

- **Specialised terminology**: precise, often single-meaning terms (*thrombosis* / تخثّر).
- **Precision and concision**: no ambiguity, no decorative language.
- **Objectivity**: impersonal style, frequent passive, few evaluative words.
- **Conventional structure**: each genre (manual, leaflet, contract, news report) follows fixed patterns.
- **Non-verbal elements**: numbers, units, formulae and tables that must be preserved.
- **Clear function**: readers use the text to do something (take a drug, sign a contract, repair a machine).

3. The translator's competence

A technical translator is neither a walking dictionary nor a subject expert. Professional competence combines (i) strong command of both languages, (ii) knowledge of the subject field, (iii) research, terminology and tool skills, and (iv) strategic decision-making (PACTE 2003). The golden rule is **understand before you translate**: if you cannot explain the source text to a non-specialist in your own words, you are not ready to translate it.

4. Three myths

- *"Technical translation is just replacing terms."* Terms are the tip of the iceberg; syntax, genre and function matter as much.
- *"Only experts can translate technical texts."* Linguists who research thoroughly often outperform experts who ignore language.

- *"Machine translation makes human translators unnecessary."* MT output must be checked, corrected and adapted (Lecture 10).

Toolkit: five questions to ask before you translate

Question	Why it matters	Example
1. Who wrote the text, and why?	Reveals purpose and authority.	A manufacturer's safety notice must be obeyed.
2. Who will read the translation?	Determines register and the amount of explanation.	Patients (lay) vs. pharmacists (expert).
3. What genre is it?	Genres have conventions to reproduce.	Leaflet headings, contract clauses, news lead.
4. Which terms are critical?	Lets you plan research before drafting.	power bank / بنك الطاقة ; hypertension / ارتفاع ضغط الدم
5. What must stay unchanged?	Numbers, units, names, formatting.	45 °C ; 400 mg ; version 3.2

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 In your own words, what makes a text "technical"? Give two examples from everyday life.

2 Which is riskier: a mistranslated poem or a mistranslated dosage instruction? Why?

3 List three skills (besides knowing two languages) that a technical translator needs.

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Safety instructions (consumer electronics)

Portable Power Bank: Safety Instructions

Read these instructions carefully before first use and keep them for future reference. Do not expose the device to water, direct sunlight or temperatures above 45 °C. Do not attempt to open, repair or modify the battery. Charge the unit only with the cable supplied. If the device becomes hot, emits a smell or changes shape, disconnect it immediately and contact an authorised service centre. The manufacturer shall not be liable for damage resulting from improper use.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

first use = الاستخدام الأول
direct sunlight = أشعة الشمس المباشرة
service centre = مركز خدمة
liable = مسؤول

WATCH OUT

- *power bank*: several Arabic equivalents exist. Choose one and justify it.
- *shall not be liable*: a legal formula inside a technical text.
- Imperatives and negative imperatives: choose one form and keep it consistent.

Before you translate

Function of the text and its readers:

Two translation problems you can already spot:

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Medical · Health-awareness text for the general public

ارتفاع ضغط الدم من الأمراض المزمنة الشائعة، وكثيرًا ما يُسمّى «القاتل الصامت» لأنه قد لا تظهر له أعراض واضحة لسنوات طويلة .ويُعدّ الإفراط في تناول الملح، والسمنة، وقلة النشاط البدني، والتدخين من أبرز عوامل الخطر .وينصح الأطباء بقياس ضغط الدم بانتظام، واتباع نظام غذائي متوازن، وممارسة الرياضة نصف ساعة يوميًا على الأقل، وعدم التوقف عن تناول الدواء دون استشارة الطبيب.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

عوامل الخطر = risk factors
النشاط البدني = physical activity
مزمن = chronic

WATCH OUT

- «القاتل الصامت»: keep, explain or replace the metaphor?
- A long chain of coordination with «و»: how will you punctuate in English?
- Register: an awareness text for non-specialists.

Before you translate

Function of the text and its readers:

Two translation problems you can already spot:

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Media · Short news item

A new bus line connecting the university campus to the city centre will start operating next Monday. The service will run every fifteen minutes from 6:30 a.m. to 9:00 p.m. Students can buy monthly passes at a reduced price.

The university has also announced that a late-evening service will be introduced during the exam period. Passengers are advised to check the timetable on the university website, where any changes will be published in advance.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Legal · Undertaking (administrative-legal)

أتعهد أنا الممضي أسفله باحترام النظام الداخلي للمكتبة، وبإرجاع الكتب المستعارة في الآجال المحددة، وبتعويض المكتبة عن أي كتاب أتلفه أو أفقده.

وأي إخلال بهذا النظام قد يترتب عنه تعليق حقي في الاستعارة مؤقتًا .كما أصرّح بأنني اطلعت على النظام وبأن المعلومات التي قدمتها في هذه الاستمارة صحيحة.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Quick-start guide (home Wi-Fi router)

Before you begin, place the router in an open, central position, away from microwave ovens and thick walls. Connect the power adapter and wait until the green light stops flashing. This usually takes about two minutes. Do not unplug the device while the light is flashing.

To connect your phone or laptop, select the network named on the label at the back of the router and enter the password printed below it. If the connection fails, press and hold the reset button for ten seconds, release it, and repeat the steps above. Note that this restores all factory settings.

Warning: Keep the router away from water and do not open its casing. Only authorised technicians may repair it. For support, call the helpline free of charge (Monday to Saturday, 8 a.m. to 6 p.m.) and have your customer number ready.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Media · Administrative notice (university enrolment)

تعلم عمادة الكلية الطلبة الجدد بأن التسجيل الإداري للسنة الجامعية 2026-2027 يتم عن بعد، ابتداءً من غرة سبتمبر وإلى غاية الخامس عشر منه، على الموقع الرسمي للجامعة، وذلك بعد سداد معلوم التسجيل.

ويتعين على كل طالب إرفاق الوثائق التالية: نسخة من شهادة البكالوريا، ونسخة من بطاقة التعريف الوطنية، وصورة شمسية حديثة، وشهادة طبية تثبت اللياقة البدنية .ولا يُقبل أي ملف ناقص أو وصل أُدلي به بعد الأجل المحدد.

وبعد استيفاء الإجراءات، يُسلَّم الطالب بطاقة الطالب في مكتب شؤون الطلبة، ويمكنه الاطلاع على جدول الدروس بداية من الأسبوع الأخير من الشهر .وللاستفسار، يرجى الاتصال بإدارة الدراسة والامتحانات.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which part of the task was hardest? Which resource (dictionary, parallel text, glossary, expert) helped most?

LECTURE

02

WEEK 2

PART A · FOUNDATIONS

Skopos, the Brief and Text Function

Why the purpose of a translation decides how it is translated

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Explain the principles of skopos theory and Nord's loyalty principle.
- Distinguish instrumental from documentary translation.
- Reconstruct a translation brief when none is given.
- Adapt one source text to two different briefs.

Lecture notes

1. From equivalence to purpose

Earlier theories asked whether a translation was *equivalent* to its source. Functionalist theories ask a different question: **what is the translation for?** In Reiss and Vermeer's *skopos* theory (Greek for "purpose"), the purpose of the target text, not the form of the source text, determines the strategy. Nord (1997) adds the principle of **loyalty**: the translator is responsible to the source author and to the target readers and must not mislead either.

2. The translation brief

Professional translators work from a **brief** (commission): who needs the translation, for what use, for which readers, in which medium, by when and why. When the client supplies none, the translator reconstructs one and, ideally, confirms it. The same source can then yield different translations, which Nord classifies as:

- **Instrumental translation**: the target text works on its own as a message in the target culture (a manual, a leaflet, a notice).
- **Documentary translation**: the target text documents the source text for readers who know they are reading a translation (a certified birth certificate, a contract used as evidence).

3. Analysing the source text

Nord's model separates **extratextual** factors (sender, intention, audience, medium, place, time, motive, function) from **intratextual** ones (subject matter, content, presuppositions, composition, non-verbal elements, lexis, syntax, tone). Reiss's text types (informative, expressive, operative) help predict what must be preserved: content, form or effect. Use these as a five-minute checklist before drafting.

Toolkit: translation brief template

Element	Key question	Example (Text A, brief 1)
Client and purpose	Who commissions it and for what use?	Building manager; posted in the entrance hall.
Readers	Who reads it? What do they know and expect?	Arabic-speaking tenants; non-lawyers.
Medium and place	Print, screen, subtitle, speech?	A4 notice on a wall.
Time and urgency	Deadline? Short-lived or long-term use?	Posted a week before the cut-off date.

Element	Key question	Example (Text A, brief 1)
Function	Inform, instruct, persuade, record?	Inform and ask readers to act (store water).
Strategy	Instrumental or documentary?	Instrumental: natural, clear MSA.

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Recall a text you translated before. What was its purpose? Did your translation serve it?

2 Why can two correct translations of the same sentence differ?

3 Give one situation where a documentary translation is required, and say why.

TEXT A **English → Arabic** · Legal · Notice to tenants (legal-administrative)

Brief 1: the building manager wants a notice for the entrance hall, addressed to tenants, in clear Modern Standard Arabic.

NOTICE TO TENANTS

Tenants are hereby notified that the water supply to the building will be interrupted on Saturday, 14 November 2026, between 9:00 a.m. and 1:00 p.m. for maintenance purposes. Tenants are advised to store sufficient water in advance. The landlord regrets any inconvenience and shall not be responsible for any loss arising from this interruption.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

landlord = المالك / المؤجّر
water supply = إمدادات المياه
maintenance = الصيانة

WATCH OUT

- *hereby notified*: archaic legal formula in an everyday notice.
- Time expressions: 9:00 a.m. / 1:00 p.m.
- *shall not be responsible for*: keep the legal force, but in natural Arabic.

Before you translate

Function and readers (brief 1):

Strategy chosen (instrumental/documentary) and why:

Your translation

Brief 2: the same last sentence must appear as a clause in a signed lease. Name two changes you would make to your translation.

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Media · Public-health announcement (press release)

Brief: (a) a full translation for the English-language website of an international health organisation; (b) a tweet of at most 280 characters.

أعلنت وزارة الصحة أن حملة التلقيح الوطنية ضد الإنفلونزا الموسمية ستنطلق الاثنين المقبل في جميع المراكز الصحية الأساسية، وتستهدف بالأساس كبار السن والحوامل والمصابين بأمراض مزمنة .ودعت الوزارة المواطنين إلى التوجه إلى أقرب مركز صحي وعدم الاستماع إلى الإشاعات المتداولة على مواقع التواصل الاجتماعي.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

التلقيح = vaccination
الإنفلونزا الموسمية = seasonal influenza
المراكز الصحية الأساسية = primary healthcare centres

WATCH OUT

- «كبار السن»: a respectful English equivalent?
- «الإشاعات المتداولة»: rumours / misinformation?
- Compression needed for the tweet: what can go?

Before you translate

Function and readers (brief a):

What changes between brief (a) and brief (b)?

Your translation

Tweet (max. 280 characters):

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Medical · Hospital instruction notice

Patients must fast for at least eight hours before the blood test. Water is permitted. Please bring your identity card and the doctor's prescription to the laboratory reception.

Results are usually available within 24 hours and can be collected from the same reception desk. If you take any regular medication, please inform the nurse before the sample is taken, as some treatments may affect the results.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Technical · Maintenance recommendation

للحفاظ على أداء الجهاز، يُنصح بتنظيف المرشح مرة كل شهر باستخدام قطعة قماش ناعمة، وعدم استعمال أي مواد كيميائية قوية.

وفي حال انخفاض قوة الشفط أو صدور ضوضاء غير معتادة عن الجهاز، يجب إيقافه فورًا وفحص الأنبوب والمرشح بحثًا عن أي انسداد .ولا ينبغي فك الجهاز بأي حال من الأحوال أثناء فترة الضمان، تفاديًا لسقوط الضمان.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Media · Visitor leaflet (museum)

Step into two thousand years of Mediterranean history. Our museum houses one of the finest collections of Roman mosaics in the world, set in a restored seaside palace. Whether you have an hour or a whole afternoon, there is something here for you.

Guided tours leave every thirty minutes from the main hall and last about an hour. Audio guides are available in six languages. Please note that flash photography is not permitted, and large bags must be left at the cloakroom. Children under twelve enter free of charge when accompanied by an adult.

Open daily except Mondays, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. (extended hours in summer). Tickets can be bought online or at the entrance. Take a break at our garden café, and don't miss the shop, where every purchase supports the conservation of the collection.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Technical · Product advertisement (solar water heater)

سخّان الشمس الجديد هو الحل الأمثل لعائلتك: ماء ساخن طوال السنة دون أن تدفع دينارًا واحدًا لفاتورة الغاز أو الكهرباء .يعتمد على ألواح مصنوعة من النحاس عالي الجودة تمتص أشعة الشمس حتى في الأيام الغائمة.

يتسع خزان الجهاز لمائة وخمسين لترًا، وهو مزوّد بعازل حراري يحفظ الماء ساخنًا ثمانٍ وأربعين ساعة .ويتم تركيبه في أقل من يوم على أيدي فنيينا المختصين، مع ضمان لمدة عشر سنوات على الألواح وخمس سنوات على الخزان.

بادروا بالاتصال بنا اليوم واستفيدوا من خصم بـ 20 بالمائة على التركيب، وبقرض ميسّر بالتعاون مع البنك الشريك .فالطاقة النظيفة ليست ترفًا، بل استثمار في مستقبل أبنائكم.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which element of the brief changed your decisions most? Did you ever feel torn between loyalty to the source and to the reader?

LECTURE

03

WEEK 3

PART A · FOUNDATIONS

Terminology and Equivalence

Concepts, terms and the art of finding Arabic equivalents

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Distinguish words from terms and translate concepts rather than strings.
- Name the main English term-formation processes and the five Arabic strategies for creating or receiving terms.
- Evaluate competing Arabic equivalents using authoritative sources.
- Build and use a personal termbase.

Lecture notes

1. Words, terms and concepts

A **term** names a concept within a specialised field. Unlike general words, terms ideally have one meaning in one field (*monosemy*), and the concept can be traced across languages through definitions. Always translate **concepts**, not strings of letters: *stress* is ضغط in psychology but إجهاد in materials science.

2. How English forms terms

- **Greek and Latin roots and affixes**: *cardio-*, *-itis*, *-ectomy*.
- **Compounding**: *software*, *firewall*.
- **Acronyms**: *DNA*, *AIDS*, *USB*. **Eponyms**: *Parkinson's disease*.
- **Semantic extension** of everyday words: *mouse*, *window*, *cloud*.

3. How Arabic creates or receives terms

Arabic uses the five main techniques in the toolkit table (Hassan 2017; Husni & Newman 2015). Hassan's study of the Microsoft Terminology Collection shows that inconsistency (several equivalents for one term, or different strategies for similar terms) is the chief weakness of Arabic IT terminology. He recommends Arabic-expanding techniques (derivation, compounding) for terms built on common roots and reserves Arabicisation mainly for proper nouns and their derivatives.

4. Managing terminology

- Consult authoritative sources: language academies (Cairo, Damascus, Amman, Baghdad), the Arabization Coordination Bureau (Rabat), Bayt al-Hikma (Carthage), the Unified Medical Dictionary, standards bodies.
- Verify in context with **parallel texts**: authentic texts of the same genre written originally in the target language.
- Record each decision in a **termbase**: term, equivalent, source, context, date.
- Be consistent: one concept, one term, throughout the text.

Toolkit: Arabic term-formation strategies

Strategy	Description	Examples
Calque (translation)	Rendering the parts of the term one by one.	cloud computing → الحوسبة السحابية
Derivation (اشتقاق)	New word on an Arabic root and pattern.	computer → حاسوب (root ح-س-ب)
Blending (نحت)	Two elements fused into one word.	amphibious → برمائي (بر + ماء)
Semantic extension	An existing word receives a new technical sense.	mouse → فأرة ; window → نافذة
Arabicisation (تعريب)	Foreign term adapted to Arabic sound and script.	vitamin → فيتامين ; virus → فيروس
Acronyms	Keep the Latin acronym or give expansion plus acronym.	AIDS → الإيدز (متلازمة نقص المناعة المكتسب)

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Name two English words now used in everyday (Tunisian) Arabic. Were they translated or borrowed?

2 Why is it a problem if a manual says «حاسوب» on page 1 and «كمبيوتر» on page 12?

3 Where would you look for a reliable Arabic equivalent of a medical term? List two sources.

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Medical · Pharmacology text (expert-to-student)

> Statins are a class of lipid-lowering drugs that inhibit HMG-CoA reductase, the enzyme responsible for cholesterol synthesis in the liver. Common adverse effects include muscle pain (myalgia) and elevated liver enzymes. Patients should report unexplained muscle weakness to their physician immediately.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

lipid-lowering = خافض للدهون

enzyme = إنزيم

liver = الكبد

WATCH OUT

- *HMG-CoA reductase*: translate, transliterate or keep the Latin script? Justify.
- *adverse effects*: at least three Arabic equivalents exist. Which suits a physician reader?
- *cholesterol*: كوليسترول / كولسترول. Choose a spelling and keep it.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which terms need research? Record two entries below (term, equivalent, source).

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Technical · IT explanatory text

تتيح الحوسبة السحابية للمؤسسات تخزين بياناتها ومعالجتها على خوادم بعيدة متصلة بالإنترنت بدلًا من الاعتماد على أجهزة محلية .ومن أبرز مزاياها المرونة في توسيع السعة وخفض كلفة البنية التحتية، غير أنها تثير مخاوف تتعلق بأمن البيانات وخصوصيتها، ولا سيما عند تخزينها في دول أخرى.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الحوسبة السحابية = cloud computing
البنية التحتية = infrastructure
الخوادم = servers

WATCH OUT

- «خصوصيتها»: privacy or confidentiality?
- «توسيع السعة»: the standard English collocation?
- «ولا سيما»: choose the right English connector.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which Arabic term-formation strategy produced «الحوسبة السحابية»?

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Technical · IT security advice

Please enable two-factor authentication and update your firewall settings. Do not share your password or download attachments from unknown senders.

Make sure that your operating system and antivirus software are up to date. If you suspect that your account has been compromised, change your password immediately and contact the IT help desk.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Medical · Medical explanation (general readers)

يُعدّ فقر الدم من أكثر اضطرابات الدم شيوعًا، وينتج غالبًا عن نقص الحديد .ومن أعراضه الشحوب والإرهاق وضيق التنفس عند بذل مجهود.

ويُشخَّص المرض بتحليل الدم الذي يقيس مستوى الهيموغلوبين .وتشمل العلاجات المكملات الغذائية الحاوية على الحديد وتعديل النظام الغذائي، وقد يلزم في الحالات الشديدة نقل الدم.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Medical · Laboratory report explanation (diabetes)

Your blood tests show a fasting glucose of 1.4 g/L and an HbA1c of 7.8%. HbA1c reflects your average blood sugar over the previous three months. A value above 6.5% is consistent with type 2 diabetes and requires medical follow-up.

Insulin resistance, in which cells respond poorly to insulin, is the main cause of the condition. It is aggravated by obesity, physical inactivity and a diet rich in refined sugars. Left untreated, chronic hyperglycaemia may damage the eyes, kidneys, nerves and blood vessels.

Treatment combines lifestyle changes, oral antidiabetic drugs and, when necessary, insulin injections. You should monitor your blood glucose at home and attend a check-up every three months. Report immediately any episode of hypoglycaemia (sweating, shaking, confusion).

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Legal · Company statute (extract, limited liability company)

تُؤسَّس بين الممضين أسفله شركة ذات مسؤولية محدودة، يُطلق عليها اسم «الأفق للتجهيزات الصناعية»، ومقرها الاجتماعي بصفاقس، ويبلغ رأس مالها خمسين ألف دينار مقسّمة إلى خمسة آلاف حصة متساوية القيمة.

يتولى التصرف في الشركة مسيّر أو أكثر يُعيَّنون من بين الشركاء أو من غيرهم بقرار من الجمعية العامة العادية .ولا يجوز للشريك أن يتنازل عن حصصه لغير الشركاء إلا بموافقة الأغلبية المطلقة لرأس المال.

تُوزَّع الأرباح الصافية بعد خصم الاحتياطي القانوني وفق حصص كل شريك، وتُسأل الشركة وحدها عن ديونها، ولا يتحمل الشركاء الخسائر إلا في حدود مساهماتهم .وتدوم الشركة تسعًا وتسعين سنة ابتداءً من تاريخ تسجيلها بالسجل التجاري.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Add the five most useful terms from this lecture to your termbase and note the source of each.

LECTURE

04

WEEK 4

PART A · FOUNDATIONS

Syntax, Style and Cohesion

Restructuring English and Arabic technical sentences

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Compare English and Arabic sentence architecture in technical writing.
- Restructure noun strings, passives and participial phrases appropriately.
- Segment and connect sentences in both directions.
- Handle numbers, units and symbols consistently.

Lecture notes

1. Different sentence architectures

English technical sentences are typically **SVO** with long chains of pre-modifiers (*high-pressure fuel injection pump*). Arabic offers verbal sentences (**VSO**) and nominal sentences, and builds noun phrases by **post-modification** and the genitive construction (الإضافة): the head noun comes first. Translating a noun string means reading it from right to left and restructuring it.

2. Voice, nominalisation and «يتم»

English technical writing prefers the passive and nominalisation. Arabic can use the true passive (يُنفَّذ), an active construction or a verbal noun. The calque «يتم + verbal noun» (يتم تنفيذ…) is widespread but heavy; prefer a true passive or an active verb when the agent is clear.

3. Cohesion and punctuation

Arabic traditionally links clauses with و and ف and tolerates long sentences; modern technical and journalistic Arabic increasingly uses shorter sentences and Arabic punctuation (، ؛ ؟). English relies on subordination and full stops. From Arabic into English, **segment** and **subordinate**; from English into Arabic, **link** with suitable connectors (إذ، حيث، بينما، غير أن).

4. Numbers, units, symbols

Tunisian and Maghrebi writers use Western digits (0–9); keep them. Units follow the SI system (°C, kg, mg); in running Arabic text use the full word or one official abbreviation consistently. Decimal and thousands separators differ by country, so follow the client's convention.

Toolkit: restructuring English patterns for Arabic

English pattern	Arabic solution	Example
Noun string	Head noun first, then genitive chain.	engine oil pressure warning light → مصباح تحذير ضغط زيت المحرك
Passive	True passive or active; limit «يتم».	The sample was heated → سُخِّنت العيّنة

English pattern	Arabic solution	Example
-ing participle	Prepositional phrase: باستخدام / عن طريق.	Using a dry cloth, wipe… → امسح… باستخدام قطعة قماش جافة
Long sentence	Split, then join with connectors.	…; however, … → … غير أنّ …
If-clause	إذا + past tense (real condition).	If the level drops… → إذا انخفض المستوى…

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Break down and translate into Arabic: *high-pressure fuel injection pump*.

2 Translate orally: *The valve is closed manually.* Which Arabic construction did you choose, and why?

3 Why is it risky to copy English punctuation one-to-one into Arabic?

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Engineering manual extract

> The high-pressure hydraulic pump is driven by the engine via a toothed belt. If the oil level drops below the minimum mark, the low-pressure warning light will come on and the system should be switched off immediately. Maintenance must be carried out by qualified personnel only.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

hydraulic pump = مضخة هيدروليكية
warning light = مصباح التحذير
qualified personnel = أفراد مؤهلون

WATCH OUT

- The noun string and its adjectives: *high-pressure hydraulic pump*.
- A conditional plus consequence in one sentence.
- Obligation in the passive: *must be carried out by*.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Mark the main verb and agent in each English sentence:

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Media · News report (one long Arabic sentence)

وقد شهدت العاصمة تونس، أمس، انطلاق أشغال المؤتمر الدولي حول الطاقات المتجددة بمشاركة خبراء من أكثر من ثلاثين دولة، حيث تناول المشاركون سبل تعزيز الاستثمار في مجال الطاقة الشمسية وطاقة الرياح، وأكدوا أهمية نقل التكنولوجيا وتكوين الكفاءات الوطنية، كما دعوا إلى تبسيط الإجراءات الإدارية التي تعيق المستثمرين.

Source: Original text written for this course (fictional news item).

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الطاقات المتجددة = renewable energies
نقل التكنولوجيا = technology transfer
الإجراءات الإدارية = administrative procedures

WATCH OUT

- One Arabic sentence of 50+ words: how many English sentences?
- «حيث» as a connector, not "where".
- «الكفاءات الوطنية»: skills, expertise or talent?

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Draw a quick plan: number of English sentences and their main verbs:

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Product specification

The battery charging time depends on the ambient temperature, which should be kept between 10 and 30 °C. If the temperature is outside this range, charging may be interrupted automatically.

Do not leave the device connected to the charger for more than twelve hours. Prolonged charging, which can reduce battery life, should be avoided, particularly when the device is covered or placed near a heat source.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **Arabic → English** · Media · Public service announcement

أعلنت الشركة الوطنية للكهرباء أنها ستقطع التيار عن بعض أحياء المدينة، يوم الأحد، من الثامنة صباحًا حتى الثانية ظهرًا، بسبب أشغال الصيانة، داعية السكان إلى اتخاذ الاحتياطات اللازمة.

وأكدت الشركة أن الأشغال تهدف إلى تحسين جودة التزويد بالكهرباء وتفادي الانقطاعات المتكررة خلال فصل الصيف، مشيرة إلى أن فرقها ستكون في عين المكان لتسريع إنجاز العمل .وستُعلَم الأحياء المعنية بأي تغيير في الموعد عبر الرسائل القصيرة.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Environmental report (extract)

The depletion of groundwater resources, which has been accelerated by intensive irrigation and by successive years of below-average rainfall, is now regarded by hydrologists as the single most pressing threat to agricultural productivity in the region.

Although desalination plants have been commissioned in several coastal governorates, their high energy consumption, and the fact that brine must be discharged safely, have limited their expansion, which is why the authorities are also encouraging farmers to adopt drip irrigation.

It was therefore recommended that water tariffs be revised, that leakage in the distribution network be reduced, and that treated wastewater be reused wherever possible. These measures, it was argued, would cost less than new dams.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Media · Opinion article (digital education)

لم يعد التعليم الرقمي خيارًا يمكن التفكير في تأجيله، بل أصبح ضرورة فرضتها التحولات التي يشهدها سوق الشغل، وعززتها تجربة الجائحة التي كشفت عن هشاشة المنظومة التقليدية وعن الفوارق الكبيرة بين التلاميذ في الحصول على الأجهزة والاتصال بالإنترنت.

غير أن اعتماد المنصات الإلكترونية وحده لا يكفي، لأن نجاحها يتوقف على تكوين المدرّسين، وعلى وجود محتوى جيد باللغة العربية، وعلى بنية تحتية تصل إلى المناطق الداخلية، وإلا تحوّلت هذه الأدوات إلى وسيلة جديدة لتعميق الفجوة التي يُراد ردمها.

ومن هنا، فإن على الوزارة أن تضع خطة واضحة تقوم على التدرج والتقييم المستمر، وأن تُشرك في ذلك المدرّسين والأولياء، فالإصلاح الذي يُفرض من فوق نادرًا ما ينجح.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which restructuring (noun string, passive, sentence splitting) was most natural, and which felt forced?

LECTURE

05

WEEK 5

PART B · MEDICAL TRANSLATION

Patient Information and Health Communication

Translating leaflets and health-education texts for lay readers

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Place medical genres on the expert-to-lay cline and identify their readers.
- Reproduce the standard structure and wording of a patient information leaflet in Arabic.
- Translate dosage, frequency and warnings with absolute precision.
- Apply plain-language principles without losing accuracy.

Lecture notes

1. Medical translation: a map of genres

Medical texts range from **expert-to-expert** genres (research articles, trial protocols, discharge summaries) to **expert-to-lay** genres (patient leaflets, consent forms, health education) (Montalt & González Davies 2007; Fischbach 1998). Errors have real consequences, so the field demands accuracy, caution and ethical awareness (Susam-Sarajeva & Spišiaková 2021).

2. The patient information leaflet (PIL)

A PIL is an instrumental, heavily regulated genre: its headings and many of its sentences are standardised. Its readers are lay patients with varying literacy, so the translator uses **plain language**: short sentences, direct address, everyday words next to the necessary medical term, and unambiguous instructions on dose and warnings.

3. Language features

- **Address**: second person and imperatives: *Take one tablet…* → تناول قرصًا واحدًا…
- **Quantities**: dose, frequency and duration must be exact (*twice daily*, *every 6 to 8 hours*, *with food*).
- **Frequency labels** for side effects follow a standard formula (see table).
- **Names**: use the international non-proprietary name (INN); brand names stay unchanged.

4. Health literacy and ethics

Never add, omit or soften safety information. If the source is unclear (e.g. "take daily"), query the client. Use one term for each symptom throughout. In Tunisia, leaflets often circulate in French and Arabic: check that your Arabic follows the approved text, not an earlier version.

Toolkit: standard PIL headings and frequency labels

English	Arabic
What X is and what it is used for	ما هو الدواء X وما دواعي استعماله
Before you take X	ما يجب معرفته قبل تناول الدواءX
How to take X	كيفية تناول الدواءX

English	Arabic
Possible side effects	الآثار الجانبية المحتملة
How to store X	كيفية حفظ الدواءX
Common (may affect up to 1 in 10 people)	شائعة (قد تصيب ما يصل إلى شخص واحد من كل 10 أشخاص)
Rare / Very rare	نادرة / نادرة جدًا

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Recall a medicine leaflet you have read. What made it easy or hard to understand?

2 Why must a leaflet translator avoid both over-technical and over-simplified language?

3 The source says "Take twice daily." What would you ask the client before translating?

TEXT A — English → Arabic · Medical · Patient information leaflet (extract)

Ibuprofen 400 mg Tablets

How to take this medicine

Always take this medicine exactly as described in this leaflet or as your doctor or pharmacist has told you. Swallow the tablets whole with a glass of water, preferably during or after a meal. Adults and children over 12 years: one tablet every 6 to 8 hours, as needed. Do not take more than three tablets in 24 hours.

Possible side effects

Common (may affect up to 1 in 10 people): nausea, heartburn, stomach pain. Stop taking the tablets and seek medical help immediately if you notice black stools or if you vomit blood.

Source: Original text written for this course in the style of standard leaflets.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

swallow whole = ابلع ... كاملًا
side effects = الآثار الجانبية
as needed = عند الحاجة

WATCH OUT

- Dose and frequency must be exact: *every 6 to 8 hours*, *in 24 hours*.
- *Adults and children over 12 years*: how do you say "over 12" accurately in Arabic?
- Unit *mg*: choose ملغ or مغ and keep it.
- Lay register: *heartburn*, *stools*.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which sentences are standardised (and could be checked against a parallel leaflet)?

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Medical · Health-education text

داء السكري مرض مزمن ينتج عن عجز البنكرياس عن إفراز كمية كافية من الأنسولين، أو عن عدم قدرة الجسم على استعمال الأنسولين المفرز بشكل فعّال .ومن أعراضه الشائعة كثرة العطش والتبوّل، والشعور بالتعب، وتأخر التئام الجروح .وإذا لم تتم السيطرة على مستوى السكر في الدم، فقد يؤدي ذلك إلى مضاعفات خطيرة تصيب القلب والكلى والعينين والأعصاب.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

البنكرياس = pancreas
الأنسولين = insulin
التئام الجروح = wound healing

WATCH OUT

- «داء السكري»: the established English name of the disease.
- «السيطرة على مستوى السكر»: control or manage?
- Keep a lay register in English.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which medical terms have standard English equivalents, and which need research?

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **English → Arabic** · Medical · Leaflet: storage and overdose sections

> Store the syrup below 25 °C in the original bottle. Once opened, use within 14 days. Keep out of the sight and reach of children. Do not use after the expiry date stated on the carton.
>
> If you take more medicine than you should, talk to a doctor or pharmacist immediately, or go to the nearest hospital emergency department. Take the pack and any remaining syrup with you so that the doctor knows what you have taken.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **Arabic → English** · Medical · Leaflet: indications, warnings and side effects

> يُستعمل هذا الدواء لعلاج الحمى والآلام الخفيفة إلى المتوسطة .لا تتجاوز الجرعة القصوى الموصى بها .استشر الطبيب إذا استمرت الأعراض أكثر من ثلاثة أيام.
>
> لا يُستعمل هذا الدواء لدى الأشخاص الذين يعانون من حساسية تجاه أحد مكوناته، ولا لدى النساء الحوامل دون استشارة الطبيب .وقد تظهر لدى بعض المرضى آثار جانبية خفيفة مثل الغثيان أو الصداع، وهي تزول عادة بعد التوقف عن العلاج.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Medical · Dietary advice sheet (high blood pressure)

High blood pressure often causes no symptoms, which is why it is called the silent killer. Over time, however, it increases the risk of stroke, heart attack and kidney failure. Reducing the amount of salt in your diet is one of the most effective steps you can take.

Aim for no more than 5 g of salt (one teaspoon) a day. Avoid processed foods, canned soups, cheese and pickles, which are often very high in salt. Read food labels carefully, and use herbs, lemon and spices instead of salt when cooking.

Eat at least five portions of fruit and vegetables a day, choose whole grains, and limit sugary drinks. Take your medication every day, even if you feel well, and do not stop it without consulting your doctor. Measure your blood pressure at home and bring the record to your appointments.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Medical · Pre-operative instruction letter (hospital)

نُعلمكم بأن عمليتكم الجراحية مبرمجة يوم الثلاثاء 13 أكتوبر على الساعة الثامنة صباحًا بقسم الجراحة العامة .

يُرجى الحضور إلى مكتب القبول قبل ساعتين من الموعد، مصحوبين ببطاقة التعريف الوطنية وبطاقة العلاج وملف التحاليل.

ويجب عليكم الامتناع عن الأكل والشرب ابتداءً من منتصف الليلة السابقة للعملية، وعن التدخين قبل ثمانٍ وأربعين ساعة على الأقل .ويُمنع تناول الأدوية المميّعة للدم دون استشارة الطبيب المعالج، مع إعلامه بأي دواء آخر تتناولونه.

يُنصح بإحضار ملابس مريحة وتجنّب المجوهرات والمساحيق .وفي صورة ظهور حرارة أو سعال أو أي عارض مرضي جديد قبل الموعد، يرجى الاتصال فورًا بالقسم على الرقم المبيّن أسفله لتأجيل العملية.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which sentence in the leaflet would be most dangerous if mistranslated? How did you protect it?

LECTURE

06

WEEK 6

PART B · MEDICAL TRANSLATION

Clinical and Research Texts

Terminology, abbreviations and ethics in expert medical discourse

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Recognise the conventions of case reports, discharge summaries and consent forms.
- Decode English medical terms from Greek and Latin elements.
- Decide when to translate, transliterate or keep an abbreviation in Latin script.
- Apply confidentiality and accuracy principles.

Lecture notes

1. Expert-to-expert genres

Research articles (IMRaD), case reports, discharge summaries and clinical protocols address specialists. The style is dense, impersonal and passive; **tense carries meaning**: past for methods, results and case narratives, present for established facts. Consent forms mix a legal formula with medical content.

2. Greek and Latin morphology

Most English medical terms are built from classical elements. Learning the building blocks (see table) lets you decode unfamiliar terms and propose Arabic equivalents following established patterns such as التهاب for *-itis* and استئصال for *-ectomy*.

3. Abbreviations, eponyms and the Latin-script question

Medical Arabic often keeps abbreviations in Latin script (ECG, MRI, CT, PCI) or gives an Arabic expansion with the abbreviation in brackets (تخطيط القلب الكهربائي (ECG)). Eponyms are normally transliterated (داء باركنسون). In Tunisia, clinical practice draws on French as well, so check what the target institution expects, and be consistent.

4. Ethics and sensitive terms

- **Confidentiality**: anonymise patient data; never paste patient texts into public online tools.
- **Accuracy**: no additions or omissions; query unclear sources.
- **False friends**: *acute* = حاد (not "sharp"); *positive test* = نتيجة إيجابية (often bad news); *benign / malignant* = خبيث / حميد.

Toolkit: Greek and Latin building blocks

Element	Meaning	Arabic pattern	Example
cardi(o)-	heart	قلب / قلبي	cardiomyopathy → اعتلال عضلة القلب
nephr(o)-	kidney	كلية / كلوي	nephritis → التهاب الكلية
-itis	inflammation	التهاب	hepatitis → التهاب الكبد
-ectomy	surgical removal	استئصال	appendectomy → استئصال الزائدة الدودية

Element	Meaning	Arabic pattern	Example
-ostomy	surgical opening	فغر	tracheostomy → فغر القصبة الهوائية
-aemia	blood condition	...الدم	anaemia → فقر الدم

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Decode and define: *gastroenteritis*, *nephrectomy*, *hypertension*.

2 Why can a "positive" test result be bad news, and how could this confuse a translator?

3 What must you do before using an online tool for a patient's discharge letter?

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Medical · Clinical case summary

> A 58-year-old male presented to the emergency department with acute chest pain radiating to the left arm. The ECG showed ST-segment elevation, and troponin levels were raised. The patient was diagnosed with acute myocardial infarction and underwent primary percutaneous coronary intervention. He was discharged on day five on aspirin, a beta-blocker and a statin. No complications were reported at the six-month follow-up.

Source: Original fictional case written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

emergency department = قسم الطوارئ
myocardial infarction = احتشاء عضلة القلب
follow-up = المتابعة

WATCH OUT

- *presented to*: medical sense (came to the hospital with).
- ECG, ST-segment, PCI: decide your abbreviation policy.
- Passive past-tense narrative: keep the case-report register.
- Drug classes: *beta-blocker*, *statin*.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Abbreviation policy chosen (and why):

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Medical · Informed-consent form (medico-legal)

أقرّ أنا الممضي أسفله بأنني تلقيتُ شرحًا وافيًا من الطبيب المعالج حول طبيعة العملية الجراحية المزمع إجراؤها وفوائدها والمخاطر المحتملة المرتبطة بها، وبأنه أُتيحت لي فرصة طرح الأسئلة والحصول على إجابات مقنعة. وأوافق طوعًا على إجراء العملية، مع علمي بأن من حقي سحب موافقتي في أي وقت قبل بدء التدخل.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الممضي أسفله = the undersigned
الطبيب المعالج = attending physician
سحب الموافقة = withdraw consent

WATCH OUT

- The formula «أقرّ أنا ... بأنني»: how do English consent forms open?
- «المزمع إجراؤها»: choose a natural participle.
- The right to withdraw must be explicit.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which parts are legal formula and which are medical content?

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1

English → Arabic · Medical · Discharge summary (extract)

The patient underwent a laparoscopic cholecystectomy under general anaesthesia. The postoperative course was uneventful and the patient was discharged on the second day. A follow-up visit is scheduled in two weeks.

At discharge, the patient was prescribed paracetamol for pain relief and advised to avoid heavy lifting for four weeks. He was instructed to return to the emergency department immediately in case of fever, persistent vomiting or worsening abdominal pain.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2

Arabic → English · Medical · Research abstract (extract)

تهدف هذه الدراسة إلى مقارنة فعالية دواءين في خفض ضغط الدم لدى مرضى السكري .شملت العينة 120 مريضًا موزعين عشوائيًا إلى مجموعتين .أظهرت النتائج فرقًا ذا دلالة إحصائية لصالح الدواء الأول.

وسُجّلت آثار جانبية خفيفة لدى 8% من المرضى، أبرزها الدوار والسعال الجاف، ولم يتوقف أي مريض عن العلاج بسبب هذه الآثار .وتوصي الدراسة بإجراء تجارب أوسع على عينات أكبر ولمدة أطول قبل تعميم النتائج.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Medical · Radiology report (chest X-ray)

Clinical information: 58-year-old male smoker with a three-week history of cough and weight loss. Technique: posteroanterior and lateral chest radiographs. Comparison: none available.

Findings: There is a 3 cm irregular opacity in the right upper lobe with spiculated margins. No pleural effusion or pneumothorax is seen. The cardiac silhouette is normal in size. The mediastinum is not widened, and the visualised bones are unremarkable.

Impression: Right upper lobe mass suspicious for primary lung malignancy. Contrast-enhanced CT of the chest and abdomen is recommended, followed by tissue sampling. The findings were discussed with the referring physician by telephone.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Medical · Abstract of a clinical study

الخلفية: يُعدّ ارتفاع ضغط الدم من أهم عوامل الخطر القلبية الوعائية في تونس .هدفت هذه الدراسة إلى تقييم فعالية برنامج للتثقيف العلاجي في تحسين مراقبة ضغط الدم لدى المرضى المتابعين بمراكز الصحة الأساسية.

الطريقة: أُجريت دراسة شبه تجريبية شملت 240 مريضًا تتراوح أعمارهم بين 40 و 70سنة، وُزّعوا عشوائيًا على مجموعتين: مجموعة تدخّل تلقت خمس حصص تثقيفية، ومجموعة شاهدة تلقت الرعاية المعتادة .وقيس ضغط الدم عند بداية الدراسة وبعد ستة أشهر.

النتائج: انخفض متوسط الضغط الانقباضي بمقدار 12 ملم زئبق في مجموعة التدخّل مقابل 4 ملم في المجموعة الشاهدة .($p < 0.001$) الخلاصة: يحسّن التثقيف العلاجي المراقبة بشكل دالّ، ويوصى بتعميمه.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

List three Greek or Latin elements you can now use to decode terms, with their Arabic equivalents.

LECTURE

07

WEEK 7

PART C · LEGAL TRANSLATION

Legal Language and Contracts

Equivalence between legal systems, formulae and obligations

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Explain why legal translation is a transfer between legal systems.
- Apply strategies for concepts without an equivalent.
- Render shall, may, binomials and archaic adverbs appropriately.
- Translate contract clauses in both directions.

Lecture notes

1. Translating between legal systems

Legal translation moves meaning between **legal systems**, not only between languages (Šarčević 1997; Cao 2007). Tunisian law belongs to the civil-law tradition (strongly influenced by French law, with Islamic-law sources in family matters); English-language texts often come from common-law systems. Many concepts lack exact equivalents: *trust*, *equity*, *consideration*, *tort*.

2. Strategies for non-equivalence

- **Functional equivalent**: nearest concept in the target system (*tort* → المسؤولية التقصيرية).
- **Formal equivalent (calque)** when no functional equivalent exists (*trust* → الصندوق الائتماني, with a note).
- **Borrowing plus gloss**, and **descriptive paraphrase** flagged in a translator's note.

3. Features of legal English

- ***Shall*** for obligation (not future), ***may*** for permission, ***shall not / may not*** for prohibition.
- **Binomials** (*null and void*, *terms and conditions*), **archaic adverbs** (*hereby, hereinafter, hereunder*) and Latin phrases (*force majeure, pro rata*).
- **Long sentences** with embedded conditions and determiners such as *said* and *such*.

4. Features of legal Arabic (Tunisian practice)

- Formulae: «بين الممضيين أسفله»; parties الطرف الأول / الطرف الثاني; closing «حُرِّر بتونس في ...».
- *Article* is **الفصل** in Tunisian codes (المادة in many Mashreq countries); *No.* is «عدد»; the dinar is «ت.د».
- Obligation: present tense (يدفع المشتري), يجب, يلتزم; permission: يجوز, يحق له; prohibition: لا يجوز, يُحظر.

Toolkit: contract formulae

English	Arabic	Note
shall (obligation)	يلتزم / يجب / present tense	Avoid future «سوف»
may (permission)	يجوز له / يحق له	Right or option
shall not	لا يجوز / يُحظر	Prohibition

English	Arabic	Note
null and void	باطل وعديم الأثر	Binomial kept
force majeure	القوة القاهرة	Fixed term
breach (of contract)	الإخلال (بالعقد)	Material breach: إخلال جسيم
terminate / rescind	إنهاء / فسخ	فسخ for breach
hereby / hereunder	بموجب هذا العقد / بمقتضاه	Often absorbed in Arabic

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why can *tort* or *consideration* not simply be translated word for word into Arabic?

2 What is the difference between *The tenant shall pay* and *The tenant will pay*?

3 Tunisian codes say «الفصل» and Egyptian codes «المادة» for *Article*. What does this tell us about target readers?

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Legal · Contract clause (termination)

Termination

Either party may terminate this Agreement by giving the other party thirty (30) days' prior written notice. The Company shall be entitled to terminate this Agreement with immediate effect if the Consultant commits a material breach of any of its obligations hereunder and fails to remedy such breach within fourteen (14) days of receiving written notice thereof. Upon termination, the Consultant shall return to the Company all documents and property belonging to it.

Source: Original text written for this course in standard contract style.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

party = الطرف

prior written notice = إشعار كتابي مسبق

material breach = إخلال جسيم

WATCH OUT

- *terminate*: إنهاء or فسخ? Which fits a termination clause?
- *shall be entitled to*, *shall return*: two different values of *shall*.
- *hereunder*, *thereof*: archaic adverbs.
- Numbers in words and figures: keep both.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Mark every *shall* / *may* and state its meaning:

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Legal · Sale contract (Tunisian style)

بين الممضيين أسفله: السيد محمد بن علي، تونسي الجنسية، صاحب بطاقة التعريف الوطنية عدد01234567 ، القاطن بسوسة، ويُشار إليه فيما يلي بـ«البائع» من جهة، والسيدة سلمى بن صالح، تونسية الجنسية، القاطنة بتونس العاصمة، ويُشار إليها فيما يلي بـ«المشتري» من جهة أخرى، تم الاتفاق على ما يلي:

الفصل الأول :يبيع البائع للمشتري، بموجب هذا العقد، السيارة الموصوفة أدناه خالية من كل رهن أو حجز، مقابل ثمن جملي قدره عشرة آلاف دينار (10.000 د.ت) يدفعه المشتري عند إمضاء هذا العقد.

الفصل الثاني :يلتزم البائع بتسليم السيارة وجميع وثائقها إلى المشتري في تاريخ إمضاء العقد.

Source: Original fictional contract written for this course; names and numbers are invented.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الممضي أسفله = the undersigned

رهن = lien

WATCH OUT

- «ثمن جملي»: lump sum or total price?
- «عدد» and the figure 10.000 د.ت: English number format.
- «من جهة أخرى ... من جهة»: formulaic party designation.
- Present-tense obligation in Arabic: *shall* in English?

Before you translate

Readers and function:

List the Arabic formulae that have fixed English equivalents:

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Legal · Lease clauses

The Tenant shall pay the monthly rent in advance, no later than the fifth day of each month. Any delay shall entitle the Landlord to charge interest at the legal rate. The Tenant may not sublet the premises without the Landlord's prior written consent.

The Landlord shall keep the premises in good repair and shall be responsible for major structural repairs. The Tenant shall bear the cost of minor maintenance and shall return the premises at the end of the lease in the same condition as at the start, normal wear and tear excepted.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Legal · Works contract clauses

يلتزم المقاول بإنجاز الأشغال في أجل أقصاه ستة أشهر ابتداءً من تاريخ إمضاء هذا العقد .وإذا تأخر عن ذلك، يُخصم من المبلغ المستحق له غرامة تأخير قدرها واحد في الألف عن كل يوم تأخير.

ويضمن المقاول جودة الأشغال لمدة سنة ابتداءً من تاريخ التسلم المؤقت، ويلتزم بإصلاح أي عيب يظهر خلال هذه المدة على نفقته الخاصة .وفي حال النزاع، تُعرض الخلافات على المحكمة المختصة بتونس بعد محاولة تسوية ودية.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Legal · Employment contract (extract)

This Agreement is made between Delta Engineering Ltd (hereinafter "the Employer") and Ms Sarra Ben Ali (hereinafter "the Employee"). The Employee shall be employed as a quality engineer, commencing on 1 November 2026, subject to a probationary period of six months, during which either party may terminate the Agreement upon fifteen days' written notice.

The Employee shall devote her full working time to the Employer's business and shall not, during the term of this Agreement, engage in any competing activity. She undertakes to keep confidential all information relating to the Employer's clients, processes and trade secrets, both during and after her employment.

In consideration of her services, the Employer shall pay the Employee a gross monthly salary of 3,200 dinars, payable on the last working day of each month. This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of Tunisia, and any dispute arising out of it shall be submitted to the competent courts of Tunis.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Legal · Power of attorney

أنا الممضي أسفله محمد بن صالح الجلاصي، المولود بتاريخ 12 جانفي 1975 بسوسة، والحامل لبطاقة التعريف الوطنية عدد04567891 ، والمقيم بنهج الحرية عدد 7 بسوسة، أصرّح بأنني أوكّل بمقتضى هذه الوكالة السيد علي بن عمر الطرابلسي ليقوم مقامي في الأمور التالية.

بيع العقار الكائن بسوسة والمسمى «الزهرة»، والمسجل بالرسم العقاري عدد12345 ، بالثمن والشروط التي يراها الوكيل مناسبة، وقبض الثمن، وإمضاء عقد البيع وجميع الوثائق المتصلة به لدى كاتب العدل وبقية الإدارات.

وقد منحتُ الوكيل في ذلك كامل الصلاحيات، وأقرّ مسبقًا بصحة كل ما يقوم به في حدود هذه الوكالة .وتحرّر هذه الوثيقة في نظيرين، وتبقى صالحة إلى غاية سحبها كتابيًا بمعرفتي.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which legal concept in this lecture had no exact equivalent? What strategy did you use, and what would you add as a translator's note?

LECTURE

08

WEEK 8

PART C · LEGAL TRANSLATION

Legislation, Judgments and Certified Translation

Official texts, documentary translation and machine translation of law

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Identify the main types of legal and official texts and their conventions.
- Apply documentary translation practices (brackets, names, dates, notes).
- Translate court and legislative formulae in both directions.
- Evaluate machine translation of legal sentences critically.

Lecture notes

1. Types of legal and official texts

Legislation, constitutions, judgments, powers of attorney, summons, notarial deeds and civil-status documents (birth, marriage, criminal-record extract, diplomas). Their authority comes from form: layout, formulae, stamps and signatures. Many require a **certified (sworn) translation** (ترجمة محلفة) by an accredited translator who signs, stamps and certifies the translation as faithful.

2. Documentary translation in practice

- Reproduce structure, numbering and paragraph order; do not "improve" the source.
- Mark non-verbal elements in square brackets: [Stamp], [Signature], [Illegible], [Handwritten].
- Transliterate personal names exactly as in the passport or ID; never translate names.
- Convert dates carefully; give both Hijri and Gregorian dates when both appear.
- Use [Translator's note: …] sparingly and visibly separate from the text.

3. Court and legislative language

Arabic judgments follow a rigid architecture: heading («باسم الشعب»), parties, facts, reasoning introduced by « حيث إن», analysis «من حيث الشكل / من حيث الأصل», operative part «قضت المحكمة». Legislative English uses *Whoever … shall be punishable by*; Arabic penal provisions use «كل من … يعاقب …».

4. Machine translation and law

Al Shehab (2013) compared Google Translate output for English legal sentences with professional human translations. Whatever the system, legal MT output is at best a rough draft: terminology, word order and legal meaning must be verified by a human before delivery (Lecture 10).

Toolkit: court and legislative formulae (Arabic → English)

Arabic	English	Note
حيث إن…	Whereas / Considering that …	Reasoning marker
من حيث الشكل	As to form (admissibility)	vs. من حيث الأصل: on the merits

Arabic	English	Note
قضت المحكمة بـ...	The court held / ruled / ordered …	Operative part
الحكم الابتدائي	First-instance judgment	Court of first instance
المستأنف / المستأنف ضده	Appellant / respondent	Appeal stage
المدعي / المدعى عليه	Claimant (plaintiff) / defendant	First instance
محكمة التعقيب	Court of Cassation	Tunisia
يعاقب ... كل من...	Whoever … shall be punished by …	Penal formula

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why must a sworn translator reproduce stamps and signatures (in brackets)?

2 How would you handle a personal name that has two possible English spellings?

3 Which English words mark the "operative part" of a judgment?

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Legal · Court judgment (appeal, extract)

> The appeal is admissible as to form, having been lodged within the statutory time limit. On the merits, the Court finds that the appellant failed to produce evidence in support of his claim. Accordingly, the Court dismisses the appeal, upholds the judgment of the court of first instance and orders the appellant to bear the costs of the proceedings.

Source: Original text written for this course in standard judgment style.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

appeal = الاستئناف

court of first instance = محكمة الدرجة الأولى

costs of the proceedings = مصاريف التقاضي

WATCH OUT

- *admissible as to form* and *on the merits* have fixed Arabic equivalents.
- *dismisses … upholds … orders*: three operative verbs.
- *statutory time limit*: المقرر قانونًا / القانوني.

Before you translate

Readers and function (documentary or instrumental?):

List the fixed formulae you recognise:

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Legal · Penal provision (legislation)

الفصل 45: يعاقب بالسجن مدة عامين وبخطية قدرها ألف دينار كل من يستعمل وثيقة مدلّسة مع علمه بتدليسها .
ويُضاعف العقاب إذا كان الفاعل موظفًا عموميًا ارتكب الفعل أثناء مباشرته لوظيفته.

Source: Fictional provision written for this course; it does not reproduce any actual law.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

- مدلّسة = forged
- خطية = fine
- موظف عمومي = public official

WATCH OUT

- «كل من ... يعاقب ...»: restructure as "Whoever ... shall be ...".
- «مع علمه بتدليسها»: knowledge (mens rea) must be kept.
- «يُضاعف العقاب»: doubled.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Where is the mental element (knowledge) expressed, and how will you render it?

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Legal · Sworn translator's certification

I, the undersigned sworn translator, certify that the foregoing is a true and faithful translation of the original birth certificate presented to me. [Signature] [Stamp]

The translation reproduces the layout of the original as far as possible. Illegible words are indicated by [illegible], and the seals and handwritten annotations appearing on the original are described in square brackets. This certificate is valid only when it bears the translator's signature and stamp.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Legal · Court reasoning and operative part

حيث إن المدعي لم يثبت وجود الضرر المزعوم، وحيث إن الأدلة المقدمة لا تكفي لإثبات مسؤولية المدعى عليه، فإن طلب التعويض يبقى دون سند قانوني.

ولهذه الأسباب، وبعد المداولة طبق القانون، قضت المحكمة علنيًا وابتدائيًا برفض الدعوى وتحميل المدعي المصاريف القانونية.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 **English → Arabic** · Legal · Regulation (data protection, extract)

Article 4. Personal data shall be processed lawfully, fairly and in a transparent manner. They shall be collected for specified, explicit and legitimate purposes and shall not be further processed in a manner that is incompatible with those purposes.

Article 5. The controller shall ensure that personal data are accurate and, where necessary, kept up to date. Data that are inaccurate shall be erased or rectified without delay. Data shall be kept in a form which permits identification of data subjects for no longer than is necessary.

Article 6. Any person whose data are processed has the right to access them, to object to their processing and to request their erasure. Any breach of the provisions of this regulation shall be punishable by a fine of up to 20,000 dinars, without prejudice to any other penalties provided for by law.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 **Arabic → English** · Legal · Civil-status certificate (birth certificate extract)

الجمهورية التونسية، وزارة الداخلية، بلدية سوسة .مضمون ولادة: وُلدت بسوسة يوم الثالث والعشرين من شهر مارس سنة ألفين وخمس، على الساعة العاشرة والنصف صباحًا، الطفلة ياسمين، بنت أحمد بن حسن العباسي وفاطمة بنت محمد الزرّوقي.

هامش: تزوجت المعنية بالأمر بتاريخ 5 سبتمبر 2026 بتونس، حسب المضمون المضمّن بدفتر الزواج عدد 876 لسنة .2026 لا يوجد أي هامش آخر.

حُرّر هذا المضمون طبق الأصل لدفتر الولادات عدد 345 لسنة2005 ، وسُلّم للمعنية بالأمر لاستعماله في ما يسمح به القانون .تونس، في 7 أكتوبر .2026 ضابط الحالة المدنية (الإمضاء والختم.)

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Draw up a short checklist for translating an official document (name, date, stamp, number, signature). Which item is easiest to forget?

LECTURE

09

WEEK 9

PART D · TECHNICAL TRANSLATION

Instructions, Manuals and Safety Texts

Usability, standardisation and the user who must act

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Explain usability (effectiveness, efficiency, satisfaction) as the criterion for instructional translation.
- Reproduce the conventions of instructions and safety warnings in Arabic.
- Handle mixed-script and numbering issues in right-to-left text.
- Deal with ambiguity in the source text responsibly.

Lecture notes

1. Documentation as a tool for action

Technical documentation (user manuals, quick-start guides, datasheets, standard operating procedures, safety notices) exists to help users complete tasks safely. Byrne (2006) frames quality as **usability**: effectiveness, efficiency and satisfaction. A translation is good if the user can act correctly on it, not if it merely mirrors the source.

2. Conventions of instructions

- **One action per step**, in chronological order, numbered.
- **Imperative mood**, second person, active voice; the same verb for the same action (always *press* for buttons, *select* for menu items).
- **Signal words** (DANGER, WARNING, CAUTION, NOTICE) follow international standards such as ISO 3864 and ANSI Z535; keep their hierarchy in Arabic.
- **Parallel structure** and consistent names for components and on-screen labels.

3. Arabic specifics

- Choose one policy and keep it: the imperative (اضغطْ) or the polite «يُرجى + verbal noun» / «يجب».
- **Mixed scripts**: product names, Latin button labels (RESET) and numerals inside right-to-left text must be checked in the final layout.
- On-screen or device labels: translate only if the product itself is localised; otherwise keep the English label and add the Arabic in brackets.

4. When the source is poor

Ambiguous or inconsistent source texts are common. Ask the author or client; if impossible, choose the safest reading, make it explicit in a translator's note, and never guess silently (Byrne 2006).

Toolkit: signal words and instruction verbs

English	Arabic	Note
DANGER	خطر	Imminent hazard: death or serious injury

English	Arabic	Note
WARNING	تحذير	Potential hazard
CAUTION	تنبيه	Minor injury or damage
NOTICE	إشعار / ملاحظة	Information or property damage
Press / Hold	اضغط / اضغط مع الاستمرار	Buttons
Select / Choose	اختر / حدِّد	Menu items
Plug in / Disconnect	وصِّل / افصل	Cables and power
Make sure that …	تأكد من أن…	Verification step

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Recall a manual you could not follow. Was the problem the text, the layout or the product?

2 Why should each step contain only one action?

3 The English says "tighten firmly" but gives no torque value. What do you do?

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Technical · User manual (maintenance procedure)

Replacing the Filter

WARNING: Switch off and unplug the appliance before removing the filter.

1. Open the filter cover by pressing the release button.
2. Remove the used filter and dispose of it according to local regulations.
3. Insert the new filter, making sure the arrow points upwards.
4. Close the cover until it clicks into place.
5. Reset the filter indicator by holding the RESET button for three seconds.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

filter = فلتر / مرشّح
release button = زر التحرير
dispose of = تخلّص من

WATCH OUT

- The signal word WARNING: use the standard hierarchy.
- Imperative consistency across the five steps.
- *until it clicks into place*: how do you express the audible click?
- Button label RESET: translate or keep?

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which verb forms and signal word will you use consistently?

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Technical · Installation guide (solar panel)

تنبيه :لا تركّب اللوح الشمسي أثناء هطول الأمطار أو عند هبوب رياح قوية.

1.اختر موقعًا مشمسًا لا تحجبه الأشجار أو المباني.

2.ثبّت الحامل على السطح باستخدام البراغي المرفقة.

3.ضع اللوح على الحامل وأحكم تثبيته.

4.صِل كابل اللوح بجهاز التحكم، مع مراعاة القطبين الموجب والسالب.

5.تحقق من أن مؤشر الشحن مضاء.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

جهاز التحكم = charge controller

القطبان الموجب والسالب = positive and negative terminals

WATCH OUT

- «تنبيه»: which English signal word, and why?
- «ثبّت … وأحكم تثبيته»: avoid repeating "fix".
- «مراعاة القطبين»: the technical sense (polarity).

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which English verbs will you use for «ثبّت» and «صِل»?

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Safety warnings

DANGER: High voltage. Disconnect the power supply before opening the cover. Only qualified electricians may carry out repairs. Failure to follow these instructions may result in death or serious injury.

WARNING: Do not use the equipment if the power cable is damaged. Wear insulating gloves and safety glasses when working near live components. After repairs, check that all covers are correctly refitted before reconnecting the power supply.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 — **Arabic → English** · Medical · Home-device instructions (blood-pressure monitor)

لقياس ضغط الدم، اجلس في وضع مريح وضع الذراع على مستوى القلب .شدّ الحزام حول أعلى الذراع، ثم اضغط على زر البدء .لا تتحرك ولا تتكلم أثناء القياس.

انتظر دقيقتين ثم أعد القياس للتأكد من النتيجة .سجّل القراءتين مع التاريخ والساعة في دفتر المتابعة، وأحضره معك إلى الطبيب .وإذا ظهرت على الشاشة رسالة خطأ، فتحقق من وضع الحزام وأعد المحاولة.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Laboratory safety notice

All persons entering the laboratory must wear a laboratory coat, safety glasses and closed shoes. Long hair must be tied back. Eating, drinking and the use of mobile phones are strictly prohibited. Failure to comply may result in immediate removal from the laboratory.

Chemicals must be handled in the fume cupboard. Never pour solvents down the sink; use the labelled waste containers provided. If a substance comes into contact with your skin or eyes, rinse immediately with plenty of water for at least fifteen minutes and inform the supervisor.

In the event of fire, press the nearest alarm, leave the room calmly by the marked exit, and gather at the assembly point in the car park. Do not use the lift. Only trained staff may use fire extinguishers, and only if it is safe to do so.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Technical · Warranty terms (washing machine)

تضمن الشركة المصنّعة هذا الجهاز ضد كل عيب في الصنع أو في المواد لمدة سنتين ابتداءً من تاريخ الشراء المبيّن بالفاتورة .ويشمل الضمان قطع الغيار ويد العمل، شريطة أن يُستعمل الجهاز طبقًا لما ورد في دليل الاستعمال.

ولا يشمل الضمان الأضرار الناجمة عن سوء الاستعمال أو عن التركيب غير المطابق للتعليمات، ولا الأعطاب التي سببها تذبذب التيار الكهربائي أو الكلس الموجود في الماء، ولا القطع القابلة للاستهلاك مثل الأنابيب والخراطيم .كما يسقط الضمان إذا فُتح الجهاز أو أُصلح من قبل شخص غير مرخّص له.

وللاستفادة من الضمان، يجب على الحريف الاتصال بمركز الخدمة بعد البيع وتقديم الفاتورة وشهادة الضمان، وتكون مصاريف النقل على عاتقه بعد انقضاء السنة الأولى.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

If you had to test your translation with a real user, which step would you test first, and why?

LECTURE

10

WEEK 10

PART D · TECHNICAL TRANSLATION

Scientific, IT and Machine Translation

Software localisation, scientific texts and post-editing

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Recognise the conventions of scientific abstracts and software documentation.
- Translate UI strings and release notes with placeholders and consistent terminology.
- Evaluate neural machine translation output for typical English–Arabic errors.
- Post-edit MT output at light and full levels.

Lecture notes

1. Scientific and engineering texts

Scientific articles follow IMRaD (Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion) and abstracts condense it. Scientific English uses **hedging** (*may*, *suggest*, *appear to*), passive voice and precise numbers. Arabic equivalents (قد، يبدو أن، تشير النتائج إلى) must stay proportionate: never turn *suggests* into *proves* (Olohan 2016; Wright & Wright 1993).

2. Software, UI strings and localisation

Localisation adapts software, websites and apps to a target locale: language, date and number formats, text direction, images and legal notices (Esselink 2000). UI strings are short, decontextualised and contain placeholders (%s, {0}). Keep placeholders intact, respect length limits and use platform terminology (e.g. the Microsoft Terminology Collection discussed by Hassan 2017).

3. Translation technology

CAT tools supply translation memories and termbases and enforce consistency. **Neural machine translation (NMT)** is fluent but can hide errors: omissions, wrong terms, agreement faults, and mistranslated numbers or negation. Arabic is demanding for MT because of its rich morphology, unvocalised script and flexible word order (Al Shehab 2013 tested Google Translate on legal sentences).

4. Post-editing

- **Light** post-editing corrects only meaning, terminology and basic grammar errors; **full** post-editing brings the text to human-translation quality.
- Check **numbers, negation, names and terms** first.
- Confidentiality: never upload confidential texts to public tools; follow client rules.

Toolkit: UI strings (English → Arabic)

English UI string	Arabic	Note
Save as…	حفظ باسم…	Keep the ellipsis
Settings	الإعدادات	Menu item
Sign in	تسجيل الدخول	Verbal noun in menus

English UI string	Arabic	Note
%d files selected	الملفات المحدّدة%d :	Keep %d; rephrase to avoid agreement
Update available	يتوفر تحديث	Short, no article
Delete account	حذف الحساب	Irreversible action: be clear

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 When did you last use machine translation? What kinds of errors did you notice?

2 Why is a UI string such as "Back" difficult to translate without context?

3 What would you check first in a machine-translated technical text?

TEXT A — English → Arabic · Technical · Software release notes

> **Release notes: Version 3.2**
>
> This update improves login security by introducing two-factor authentication. Users can now back up their files automatically to the cloud. Known issue: the application may crash if more than 500 files are synchronised at once. We recommend that you update your password after installing this version.

Source: Original text written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

two-factor authentication = المصادقة الثنائية
synchronise = مزامنة
release notes = ملاحظات الإصدار

WATCH OUT

- *back up* (verb) versus *backup* (noun).
- *the cloud* in a software context.
- *Known issue*: standard label in release notes.
- Register: formal-friendly, addressed to users.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which terms come from established software terminology?

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Technical · Scientific abstract (agronomy)

هدفت هذه الدراسة إلى تقييم فعالية نظام ري ذكي يعتمد على مستشعرات رطوبة التربة في ترشيد استهلاك المياه في الزراعة بالمناطق الجافة .أُجريت التجربة على عشرين حقلًا في ولاية القيروان خلال موسم زراعي كامل . وأظهرت النتائج أن النظام خفّض استهلاك المياه بنسبة 30% في المتوسط دون تأثير سلبي ذي دلالة إحصائية على المردود .وتوصي الدراسة بتعميم هذه التقنية على صغار الفلاحين مع توفير الدعم المالي اللازم.

Source: Original fictional abstract written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

ري ذكي = smart irrigation
مستشعرات رطوبة التربة = soil-moisture sensors
دلالة إحصائية = statistical significance

WATCH OUT

- «ولاية القيروان»: the English administrative term.
- «المردود»: yield.
- «ترشيد الاستهلاك»: rationalising or reducing consumption?

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Map the abstract onto IMRaD (aim, methods, results, recommendation):

Your translation

TEXT C

Post-editing (English → Arabic) · Technical · Post-editing task (illustrative MT-style draft)

ENGLISH SOURCE

This update improves login security by introducing two-factor authentication. Users can now back up their files automatically to the cloud.

RAW MT OUTPUT (ARABIC)

هذا التحديث يحسن أمن تسجيل الدخول من خلال تقديم مصادقة عاملين .يمكن للمستخدمين الآن إعادة ملفاتهم تلقائيا إلى الغيمة.

Source: Draft written for teaching purposes to illustrate typical MT errors; it was not produced by a specific system.

Before you translate

Post-edited Arabic (full post-editing):

Your translation

List the errors you corrected and classify them (terminology, mistranslation, agreement, style, spelling):

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Technical · Software interface messages

> Your session has expired. For your security, you have been signed out automatically. Please sign in again to continue.
>
> Storage almost full: 95% used. Delete unused files or upgrade your plan to continue uploading. Unable to connect to the server? Check your internet connection and try again.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Technical · Technology news / popular science

> تُظهر الدراسات أن استخدام الألواح الشمسية في المباني يمكن أن يخفض فاتورة الكهرباء بنسبة تصل إلى40% ، غير أن كلفة التركيب الأولية ما تزال عائقًا أمام كثير من الأسر.
>
> وتشير دراسة أخرى إلى أن دمج البطاريات المنزلية مع الألواح الشمسية يتيح تخزين الطاقة الفائضة واستعمالها ليلًا، ما يرفع نسبة الاكتفاء الذاتي من الكهرباء إلى 70% تقريبًا .ويرى الخبراء أن تطوير آليات التمويل الميسّر سيكون حاسمًا لانتشار هذه الحلول.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Technical · Privacy policy (extract)

We collect information you provide when you create an account, such as your name, email address and password. We also collect technical data automatically, including your IP address, browser type and the pages you visit, using cookies and similar technologies.

We use this information to provide and improve our services, to personalise content and to protect our users against fraud. We do not sell your personal data to third parties. We may share it with trusted service providers who process it on our behalf under strict confidentiality obligations.

You can access, correct or delete your data at any time from your account settings. You may also disable cookies in your browser, although some features may then stop working. If you have any question about this policy, please contact our data protection officer.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Technical · Engineering research abstract (solar desalination)

تتناول هذه الورقة تصميم نموذج أولي لوحدة تحلية مياه تعمل بالطاقة الشمسية، موجّه إلى المناطق الصحراوية التي يتعذّر فيها الاتصال بالشبكة الكهربائية .ويعتمد النموذج على مقطّر شمسي ذي حوض مائل مزوّد بمكثّف خارجي.

أُجريت التجارب في مدينة توزر خلال شهر جويلية، وقيس الإنتاج اليومي من الماء العذب في ظروف مناخية مختلفة .وأظهرت النتائج أن الإنتاجية بلغت 4.2 لترات للمتر المربع في اليوم، أي بزيادة 35 بالمائة مقارنة بالمقطّر التقليدي.

ويُستنتج من ذلك أن تحسين العزل الحراري وإضافة المكثّف الخارجي يرفعان المردودية دون زيادة معتبرة في الكلفة .وتوصي الدراسة بتجريب النموذج على نطاق أوسع وتقييم مدى تحمّله لمياه شديدة الملوحة.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

In your own words, when would you accept raw MT, light post-editing, full post-editing, or refuse MT altogether?

LECTURE

11

WEEK 11

PART E · MEDIA TRANSLATION

News Translation

Transediting, headlines and the voice of the reporter

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Explain news translation as transediting.
- Translate headlines and leads using the target language's conventions.
- Choose reporting verbs and attribution formulae accurately.
- Adapt names, dates and numbers to the target readership.

Lecture notes

1. News translation is transediting

News translators rarely translate everything: they select, condense, reorder and rewrite for a new audience, a process called **transediting** (Stetting 1989; Bielsa & Bassnett 2009). News follows the **inverted pyramid**: the most important information comes first, so the headline and lead carry the story.

2. Headlines

- English headlines use the present tense for past events, drop articles and auxiliaries and prefer short words.
- Arabic headlines are often nominal («ارتفاع صادرات …») or use the present tense; do not imitate English article-dropping.
- A headline is a mini-text with its own function: to attract and to inform.

3. Attribution, reporting verbs and neutrality

Reporting verbs convey stance: *said* / قال, *stressed* / أكّد, *warned* / حذّر. Choose the verb that matches the source, not a more dramatic one. Loaded vocabulary must follow the target outlet's style guide and the brief; the translator does not add or remove stance. Use established forms for names and institutions and transliterate consistently.

4. Language choices

- Modern Standard Arabic is the norm in written news; Maghrebi outlets may use جانفي، فيفري and «بالمائة». Decide according to the readership and style guide.
- Time words (*yesterday*, *on Tuesday*) may need adjusting to the publication date.
- Quotations must be accurate; indirect speech needs tense and pronoun shifts.

Toolkit: headlines and reporting verbs

English	Arabic	Note
Tunisia, EU sign green-hydrogen deal	تونس والاتحاد الأوروبي يوقّعان اتفاقًا بشأن الهيدروجين الأخضر	Present for past
Inflation eases to 7%	تراجع التضخم إلى7%	Nominal headline

English	Arabic	Note
Olive oil exports up 12%	ارتفاع صادرات زيت الزيتون بنسبة12%	Added «بنسبة»
said / stressed	قال / أكّد	Neutral / emphatic
warned / called for	حذّر / دعا إلى	Reporting verbs
according to	وفقًا لـ / بحسب	Attribution

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Compare the headlines of the same story in two outlets or languages. What differs?

2 Why is *said* often safer than a dramatic reporting verb?

3 What would you do with a quotation you suspect is inaccurate in the source?

TEXT A

English → Arabic · Media · News report (Tunisian readership)

> Tunisia's Ministry of Transport announced on Tuesday that the new high-speed bus network linking Tunis, Sousse and Sfax will begin operating in January. According to the ministry, the project, which is partly funded by an international loan, is expected to cut travel times by up to 40 per cent. Critics, however, say that ticket prices remain unclear.

Source: Original fictional news item written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

high-speed bus network = شبكة الحافلات السريعة
travel times = مدة التنقل
critics = منتقدون

WATCH OUT

- Month names and «بالمائة» for a Tunisian readership.
- *According to the ministry*: attribution.
- Non-restrictive clause: *which is partly funded…*.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Most newsworthy element (lead):

Your translation

Arabic headline (maximum 10 words):

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Media · News report with quotations

أكد وزير الصحة أن بلاده «ستواصل دعم البحث العلمي» في مجال الأمراض المعدية، مشيرًا إلى أن عدد الإصابات تراجع بنسبة 15 بالمائة مقارنة بالسنة الماضية. وأضاف في تصريح للصحفيين على هامش المؤتمر أن «التحدي الأكبر يظل في تغيير السلوكيات». من جهتها، حذّرت منظمة الصحة العالمية من أن التراخي قد يؤدي إلى عودة الوباء.

Source: Original fictional news item written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

على هامش المؤتمر = on the sidelines of the conference

WATCH OUT

- «الوباء» versus «الجائحة»: epidemic or pandemic?
- Quotations: render in direct or indirect speech?
- «من جهتها»: "for its part".
- «التراخي»: complacency or laxity?

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which reporting verbs appear, and what stance does each convey?

Your translation

English headline (maximum 10 words):

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Media · Health news report

Doctors warned on Monday that the number of flu cases is expected to peak in January, urging the public to get vaccinated as early as possible. "Vaccination remains the best protection," said the head of the national health agency.

Health officials said that pharmacies and primary healthcare centres have received additional stocks of the vaccine, which is free for people over 65 and for those with chronic illnesses. Meanwhile, schools were asked to remind parents of basic hygiene measures.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Media · Court news report

قضت المحكمة الابتدائية بتونس بسجن مدير شركة مدة ثلاث سنوات بعد إدانته بتهمة التحيل، كما ألزمته بدفع تعويض للمتضررين .ويمكن استئناف الحكم في أجل عشرة أيام.

من جهته، نفى محامي الدفاع التهم الموجهة إلى منوّبه وأكد أنه سيطعن في الحكم أمام محكمة الاستئناف، معتبرًا أن الملف يفتقر إلى أدلة كافية .أما هيئة الدفاع عن المتضررين فرحبت بالحكم ودعت إلى تسريع إجراءات التعويض.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1 — **English → Arabic** · Media · Press release (central bank decision)

The Central Bank announced on Tuesday that it had raised its key interest rate by 50 basis points to 8.25 per cent, citing persistently high inflation, which stood at 7.1 per cent in September. It was the third increase this year.

"Our priority is to bring inflation back to a sustainable level without choking growth," the Governor told reporters, adding that the bank "will not hesitate to act again" if price pressures persist. Analysts had expected a smaller rise of 25 basis points.

The decision is likely to make borrowing more expensive for households and businesses. Meanwhile, the dinar edged up against the euro, while the stock exchange closed slightly lower. The next meeting of the monetary policy committee is scheduled for December.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2 — **Arabic → English** · Media · Editorial (water scarcity)

لم يعد العطش مشهدًا بعيدًا عن حياة التونسيين .فمع بداية كل صيف، تتعالى الشكاوى من انقطاع الماء في أحياء كاملة، وتُرفع قوارير الماء إلى الشرفات كأنها كنز، بينما تعلن السلطات برنامجًا جديدًا للتقنين.

وليس الجفاف وحده المسؤول، فشبكة التوزيع المهترئة تُضيّع ما يقارب ثلث المياه المنتجة، والفلاحة المسقية تستهلك الجزء الأكبر من الموارد، دون أن تُراجَع تعريفات المياه أو سياسات الري منذ سنوات طويلة.

إن الحديث عن «أزمة مياه» يخفي أزمة حوكمة .فما دامت الدولة تؤجّل القرارات الصعبة، فلن تنقذنا الأمطار وحدها، ولن ينفع الاعتذار عن الانقطاعات عندما تجفّ السدود.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Which choices in your translation were editorial (cutting, reordering) rather than strictly translational? Were they justified by the brief?

LECTURE

12

WEEK 12

PART E · MEDIA TRANSLATION

Audiovisual, Social Media and Campaign Texts

Subtitling, transcreation and a course synthesis

By the end of this lecture you will be able to:

- Apply spatial and temporal subtitling constraints.
- Handle orality, dialect and cultural references in audiovisual texts.
- Distinguish translation from transcreation in campaign texts.
- Integrate the course workflow in a final portfolio task.

Lecture notes

1. Audiovisual translation

AVT includes subtitling, dubbing, voice-over and audio description (Díaz Cintas & Remael 2007). Subtitles face **spatial** limits (two lines, about 35–42 characters per line) and **temporal** limits (about 1 to 6 seconds on screen; reading speed around 12–17 characters per second). The result is **condensation**: keep what matters, drop repetitions, fillers and forms of address.

2. Subtitling conventions

- Break lines at syntactic units; avoid separating article and noun or verb and object.
- In a two-speaker subtitle, begin each speaker's line with a dash.
- Arabic subtitles read right to left: check the position of punctuation and Latin hashtags.
- **Orality**: spoken language must sound spoken. Dialect (e.g. Tunisian derja) in the source becomes natural, neutral target-language speech; identity markers may be signalled lightly.

3. Social media and campaigns

Campaign and social-media texts are **operative**: short, rhythmic, emotional, often with hashtags and calls to action. Translators often **transcreate**: they recreate the effect rather than the words, respecting cultural and religious sensitivities. Public-health communication shows how clarity, trust and cultural fit save lives (Susam-Sarajeva & Spišiaková 2021).

4. Course synthesis

You now have a method: **ANALYSE** the brief and text type; **RESEARCH** terms and parallel texts; **DRAFT** with the target genre in mind; **REVISE** for accuracy, terminology, language and function; **REFLECT** in your log. Apply it to your final portfolio.

Toolkit: subtitling norms

Parameter	Guideline	Why
Lines per subtitle	Maximum 2	Screen space
Characters per line	About 35–42, spaces included	Readability
Duration	Between 1 and 6 seconds	Time to read

Parameter	Guideline	Why
Reading speed	About 12–17 characters per second	Depends on audience
Line breaks	At syntactic or rhythmic boundaries	Comprehension
Dialogue	Dash at the start of each speaker's line	Speaker change

Warm-up: think and discuss

1 Why do subtitles usually say less than the speaker?

2 What is the difference between translating and transcreating a slogan?

3 Should Tunisian dialect be subtitled into Modern Standard Arabic? Discuss both sides.

TEXT A — **English → Arabic** · Media · Public-health video (subtitles)

Brief: Arabic subtitles for a 12-second public-health video. Maximum 2 lines per subtitle, about 35 characters per line.

1 [00:01 to 00:03] Did you know that most infections spread through our hands?

2 [00:03 to 00:06] Washing them takes just twenty seconds.

3 [00:06 to 00:09] Use soap and water. Rub your palms, your fingers, and under your nails.

4 [00:09 to 00:11] Small habits protect everyone. #CleanHandsSaveLives

Source: Original script written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

infections = العدوى
rub = فرك
nails = الأظافر

WATCH OUT

- Condensation: what can you cut without losing information?
- Line breaks at natural phrases.
- The hashtag: translate, adapt or keep?

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Number of characters in your longest line:

Your translation

TEXT B

Arabic → English · Media · TV drama dialogue in Tunisian Arabic (subtitles)

Brief: English subtitles for an international streaming platform. Maximum 2 lines per subtitle, about 42 characters per line.

–شنوّة الأخبار؟ عملت الفحوصات؟

–إي، عملتهم الصباح .الطبيب قال ما فما حتى مشكل، الحمد لله.

–يا لطيف !خفت عليك برشا.

–ما تخافش، أنا بخير .أما لازمني نرتاح شوية.

Source: Original dialogue written for this course.

TERMINOLOGY BANK

الحمد لله = thank God

WATCH OUT

- Tunisian derja markers: شنوّة، فما، برشا، لازمني: identify and render naturally.
- Condense, but keep the emotional message.
- Speaker-change dashes and the 2-line limit.

Before you translate

Readers and function:

Which derja items did you recognise, and how did you render them?

Your translation

Extra practice: two two-paragraph texts

Apply the workflow independently: analyse the brief and text type, research terms, then translate.

PRACTICE 1 **English → Arabic** · Media · Campaign copy (transcreation)

Poster: "Protect yourself, protect others: get vaccinated. One vaccine, one future."

Social media post: "Don't wait for symptoms. Check your blood pressure today at your nearest health centre! Share this message with someone you care about. #CheckYourHeart"

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

PRACTICE 2 **Arabic → English** · Media · Drama subtitles (Tunisian Arabic)

–وين الدكتور؟

–في غرفة العمليات، الجراحة توّا بدات.

–يخرج قريب؟

–ما نعرفش، أما خليك هنا واستنى.

–ها الدكتور جاي!

–شنوّة قال؟ العملية نجحت؟

–إي، نجحت .قال لازمو يرتاح، وباش نقدروا نشوفوه غدوة.

–الحمد لله.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

Texts: two extended passages

Translate each full text as a professional task: define the brief, build a mini-termbase, draft, revise, and note your decisions in the log.

TEXT 1

English → Arabic · Media · Radio advertisement script (blood donation)

[SOUND: heartbeat, then a phone ringing] VOICE 1: Hello? Is that you, Dad? VOICE 2: Yes, my dear. I'm at the hospital. I'm fine, but I needed blood last night. A stranger saved my life.

NARRATOR: Every three seconds, someone somewhere needs blood. One donation takes only twenty minutes, yet it can save up to three lives. You don't need to be a hero. You only need to be healthy, over eighteen, and willing.

NARRATOR: This Saturday, give blood at the Sousse Regional Blood Transfusion Centre, from 8 a.m. to 2 p.m. Bring your ID. Be someone's stranger. Give blood. Give life. [SOUND: heartbeat fades out]

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TEXT 2

Arabic → English · Media · Campaign speech (road safety)

أيها الحضور الكريم، نجتمع اليوم لا لنعدّد الأرقام، بل لنتذكر الوجوه .فكل عام يفقد الآلاف من التونسيين أرواحهم على الطرقات، وكل رقم من هذه الأرقام أمٌّ ثكلى أو طفلٌ يتيم أو شابٌّ لم يكمل حلمه.

نعلم جميعًا أن السرعة المفرطة واستعمال الهاتف أثناء السياقة وعدم ربط حزام الأمان هي أسباب معظم الحوادث .ومع ذلك، نواصل ارتكاب هذه الأخطاء كأن الأمر لا يعنينا .إن القانون لا يكفي وحده، فالوعي هو الذي يحمي.

لذلك أدعوكم اليوم إلى عهد جديد: لن أسرع، ولن أكتب رسالة وأنا أسوق، ولن أترك أحدًا من أحبائي يركب دون حزام .فلنجعل من طرقنا مكانًا آمنًا، ولنعد كلنا سالمين إلى بيوتنا.

Source: Original text written for this course.

Your translation

TRANSLATOR'S LOG

Final portfolio checklist: (1) three translations from the course (one from each of three domains) with your revisions; (2) your termbase; (3) your translator's log with at least five entries; (4) a one-page reflection on your own progress.

Technical Word Lists

English–Arabic terms for the four fields of the course (verify against current sources before professional use)

MEDICAL TERMS

symptom	عَرَض	myocardial infarction	احتشاء عضلة القلب
sign (clinical)	علامة سريرية	stroke	سكتة دماغية
diagnosis	تشخيص	diabetes	داء السكري
prognosis	إنذار (مآل)	insulin	الأنسولين
treatment	علاج	tumour	ورم
side effect	أثر جانبي	biopsy	خزعة
dose	جرعة	anaesthesia	تخدير
prescription	وصفة طبية	surgery	جراحة
contraindication	مانع استعمال	discharge (from hospital)	خروج من المستشفى
allergy	حساسية	follow-up	متابعة
chronic	مزمن	outpatient	مريض خارجي
acute	حاد	inpatient	مريض داخلي
benign	حميد	emergency department	قسم الطوارئ
malignant	خبيث	clinical trial	تجربة سريرية
inflammation	التهاب	informed consent	موافقة مستنيرة
infection	عدوى	medical record	ملف طبي
vaccine	لقاح	pharmacist	صيدلي
antibiotic	مضاد حيوي	laboratory	مخبر (مختبر)
painkiller (analgesic)	مسكّن للألم	blood test	تحليل الدم
blood pressure	ضغط الدم	X-ray / MRI	الأشعة السينية / الرنين المغناطيسي

LEGAL TERMS

contract	عقد	burden of proof	عبء الإثبات
party	طرف	limitation period	التقادم
clause	بند	lawsuit (action)	دعوى
article (of a code)	فصل (مادة)	force majeure	القوة القاهرة
obligation	التزام	lease	عقد إيجار (كراء)
breach	إخلال	tenant / landlord	مستأجر (مكتري) / (مؤجّر)
termination	إنهاء	power of attorney	وكالة (توكيل)
rescission	فسخ	notary	موثّق
liability	مسؤولية	sworn translator	مترجم محلّف
damages	تعويض عن الضرر	fine	غرامة (خطية)
claimant (plaintiff)	مدع	imprisonment	سجن
defendant	مدعى عليه	offence (misdemeanour)	جريمة (جنحة)
appellant	مستأنف	legislation	تشريع
judgment	حكم	decree	مرسوم
appeal	استئناف	constitution	دستور
court	محكمة	arbitration	تحكيم
first instance	الدرجة الأولى	amicable settlement	تسوية ودية
jurisdiction	اختصاص قضائي	warranty	ضمان
witness	شاهد	null and void	باطل وعديم الأثر
evidence	أدلة (إثبات)	the undersigned	الممضي أسفله

Technical Word Lists

English–Arabic terms for the four fields of the course (verify against current sources before professional use)

TECHNICAL TERMS

software	برمجيات	battery	بطارية
hardware	عتاد (مكونات مادية)	circuit	دارة
application	تطبيق	voltage	جهد (توتر) كهربائي
database	قاعدة بيانات	current	تيار
server	خادم	resistor	مقاومة
network	شبكة	switch	مفتاح
cloud computing	الحوسبة السحابية	pump	مضخة
firewall	جدار الحماية	valve	صمام
password	كلمة المرور	filter	مرشّح
update	تحديث	torque	عزم الدوران
install	تثبيت	pressure	ضغط
download	تنزيل	maintenance	صيانة
upload	رفع (تحميل)	solar panel	لوح شمسي
backup	نسخ احتياطي	renewable energy	الطاقات المتجددة
file / folder	ملف / مجلد	user manual	دليل المستخدم
browser	متصفح	troubleshooting	استكشاف الأخطاء وإصلاحها
encryption	تشفير	gearbox	علبة السرعة
artificial intelligence	الذكاء الاصطناعي	warning light	مصباح تحذير
algorithm	خوارزمية	specifications	مواصفات
sensor	مستشعر (حسّاس)	two-factor authentication	المصادقة الثنائية

MEDIA TERMS

headline	عنوان رئيسي	documentary	فيلم وثائقي
lead (intro)	مقدمة الخبر	advertisement	إعلان
news agency	وكالة أنباء	campaign	حملة
press release	بلاغ صحفي (بيان صحفي)	slogan	شعار
press conference	ندوة صحفية	hashtag	وسم (هاشتاغ)
correspondent	مراسل	social media	مواقع التواصل الاجتماعي
editor-in-chief	رئيس التحرير	follower	متابع
journalist	صحفي	post	منشور
source	مصدر	viral	منتشر على نطاق واسع
eyewitness	شاهد عيان	fake news	أخبار زائفة
interview	حوار (مقابلة)	misinformation	معلومات مضللة
broadcast	بث	fact-checking	التحقق من الأخبار
live	مباشر	editorial	افتتاحية
breaking news	خبر عاجل	op-ed	مقال رأي
viewer	مشاهد	column	عمود صحفي
audience	جمهور	circulation	توزيع (سحب)
subtitle	ترجمة مصاحبة (نصية)	censorship	رقابة
dubbing	دبلجة	copyright	حقوق المؤلف
voice-over	تعليق صوتي	trailer	مقطع دعائي
script	سيناريو (نص)	caption	تعليق توضيحي

My Termbase

Record every term you research: concept, equivalent, source, context

English term	Arabic equivalent	Source	Context and notes

Bibliography

Works cited in this booklet and recommended reading

CORE COURSE BOOKS

Baker, M. (2018). *In other words: A coursebook on translation* (3rd ed.). Routledge.

Byrne, J. (2006). *Technical translation: Usability strategies for translating technical documentation*. Springer.

Fischbach, H. (Ed.). (1998). *Translation and medicine*. John Benjamins.

Hann, M. (1992). *The key to technical translation: Vol. 1. Concept specification*. John Benjamins.

Husni, R., & Newman, D. L. (2015). *Arabic–English–Arabic translation: Issues and strategies*. Routledge.

Malmkjær, K. (Ed.). (2022). *The Cambridge handbook of translation*. Cambridge University Press.

Nord, C. (1997). *Translating as a purposeful activity: Functionalist approaches explained*. St Jerome.

Olohan, M. (2016). *Scientific and technical translation*. Routledge.

Susam-Sarajeva, Ş., & Spišiaková, E. (Eds.). (2021). *The Routledge handbook of translation and health*. Routledge.

Wright, S. E., & Wright, L. D. (Eds.). (1993). *Scientific and technical translation*. John Benjamins.

ARTICLES ON ARABIC TERMINOLOGY AND MACHINE TRANSLATION

Al Shehab, M. (2013). The translatability of English legal sentences into Arabic by using Google Translation. *International Journal of English Language and Linguistics Research, 1*(3), 18–31.

Hassan, S. S. (2017). Translating technical terms into Arabic: Microsoft Terminology Collection (English–Arabic) as an example. *Translation & Interpreting, 9*(2). https://doi.org/10.12807/ti.109202.2017.a05

TRANSLATION THEORY AND ARABIC–ENGLISH CONTRAST

Dickins, J., Hervey, S., & Higgins, I. (2017). *Thinking Arabic translation* (2nd ed.). Routledge.

Hatim, B., & Mason, I. (1997). *The translator as communicator*. Routledge.

Munday, J. (2016). *Introducing translation studies* (4th ed.). Routledge.

Newmark, P. (1988). *A textbook of translation*. Prentice Hall.

PACTE. (2003). Building a translation competence model. In F. Alves (Ed.), *Triangulating translation* (pp. 43–66). John Benjamins.

Pym, A. (2014). *Exploring translation theories* (2nd ed.). Routledge.

Reiss, K., & Vermeer, H. J. (2013). *Towards a general theory of translational action: Skopos theory explained* (C. Nord, Trans.). Routledge.

MEDICAL, LEGAL, TECHNICAL AND MEDIA TRANSLATION

Bell, A. (1991). *The language of news media*. Blackwell.

Bielsa, E., & Bassnett, S. (2009). *Translation in global news*. Routledge.

Bowker, L. (2002). *Computer-aided translation technology: A practical introduction*. University of Ottawa Press.

Cao, D. (2007). *Translating law*. Multilingual Matters.

Díaz Cintas, J., & Remael, A. (2007). *Audiovisual translation: Subtitling*. St Jerome.

Esselink, B. (2000). *A practical guide to localization*. John Benjamins.

Montalt, V., & González Davies, M. (2007). *Medical translation step by step*. St Jerome.

Mossop, B. (2020). *Revising and editing for translators* (4th ed.). Routledge.

Šarčević, S. (1997). *New approach to legal translation*. Kluwer Law International.

Stetting, K. (1989). Transediting: A new term for coping with the grey area between editing and translating. In G. Caie et al. (Eds.), *Proceedings from the Fourth Nordic Conference for English Studies* (pp. 371–382). University of Copenhagen.

Tiersma, P. M. (1999). *Legal language*. University of Chicago Press.

ARABIC LANGUAGE AND REFERENCE WORKS

Holes, C. (2004). *Modern Arabic: Structures, functions, and varieties* (Rev. ed.). Georgetown University Press.

Ryding, K. C. (2005). *A reference grammar of Modern Standard Arabic*. Cambridge University Press.

Wehr, H. (1994). *A dictionary of modern written Arabic* (J. M. Cowan, Ed.; 4th ed.). Spoken Language Services.

TERMINOLOGY RESOURCES (CONSULT THE LATEST EDITIONS AND ONLINE VERSIONS)

Unified Medical Dictionary / القاموس الطبي الموحد (English–French–Arabic). Arab League Educational, Cultural and Scientific Organization, with the Council of Arab Health Ministers and the World Health Organization.

Arabic language academies (Cairo, Damascus, Amman, Baghdad); Arabization Coordination Bureau, Rabat (مكتب تنسيق التعريب); Bayt al-Hikma, Carthage (بيت الحكمة).

Microsoft Language Portal (Terminology Collection); IATE (EU terminology database); World Health Organization Arabic-language publications.